UNIT 1

Understanding Gender

definition • concepts • attitudes • construction • socialization • caste

1. Introduction: Definition of Gender

Gender = the socially & culturally constructed roles, behaviours, activities and attributes that a society considers "appropriate" for women, men and other gender identities. It is learnt, not born with, and it changes with time, place and culture.

Sex = BIOLOGICAL (born with) vs Gender = SOCIAL (learnt)

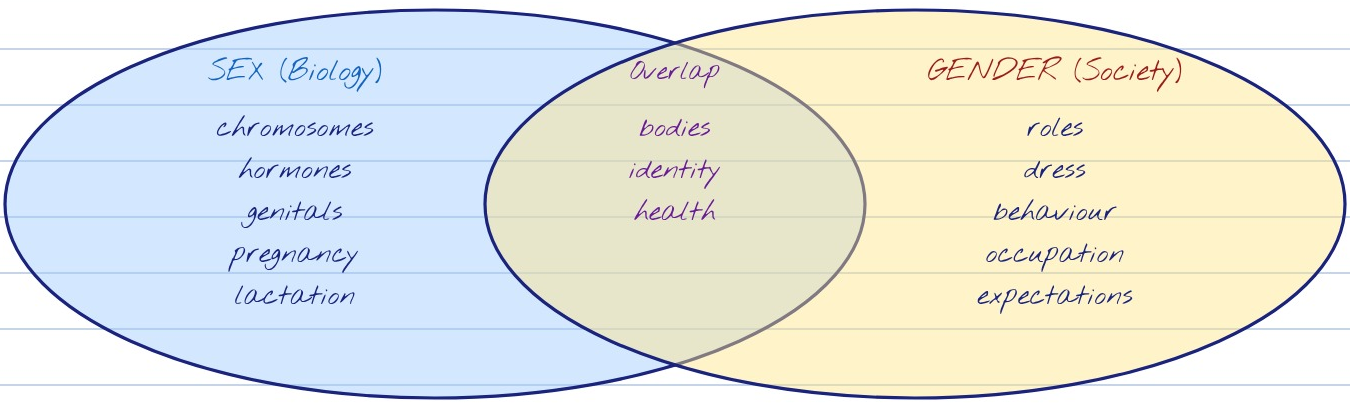
Q1. Define gender. How is it different from sex?

Ans. Sex refers to biological differences (chromosomes, hormones, reproductive organs). Gender refers to the social meanings attached to those differences.

› Sex is **natural, universal, fixed** (mostly); gender is **cultural, variable, changeable.**

› Example: only women can give birth (sex); cooking is "women's work" (gender).

Basis	SEX	GENDER
Origin	Biological, by birth	Social, learnt after birth
Nature	Fixed or universal	Varies by culture & time
Change	Cannot change easily	Can change (roles evolve)
Example	Women menstruate, men have beard	Girls = soft, boys = tough
Category	Male or Female or Intersex	Masculine or Feminine or Trans etc.



2. Basic Gender Concepts and Terminology

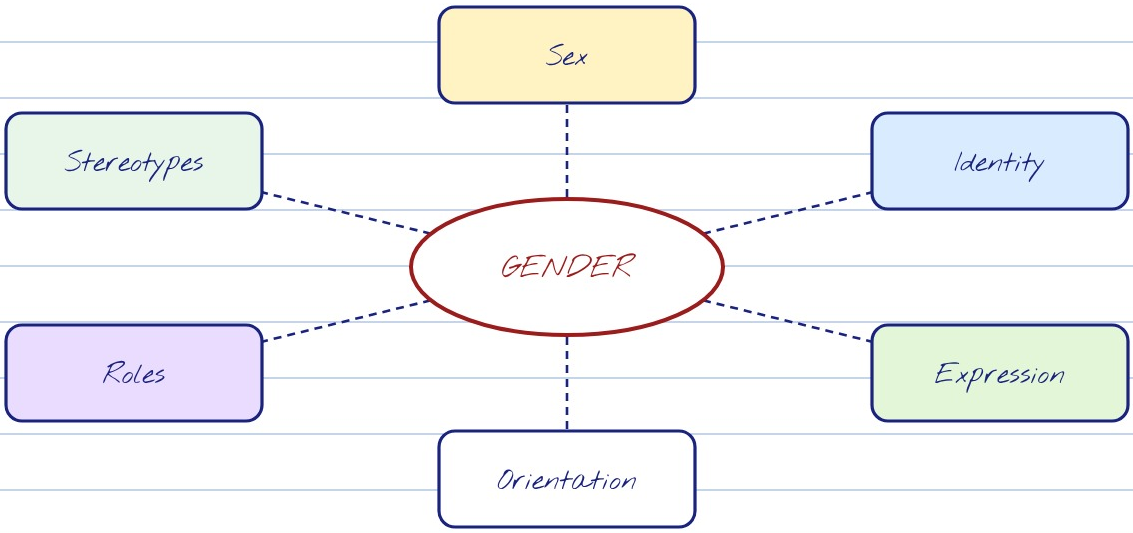
Q2. Explain the basic terms used in gender studies.

› **Sex** : biological classification at birth (male, female, intersex).

› **Gender** : social roles & expectations attached to sex.

› **Gender identity** : a person's inner sense of being a woman, man, both or neither.

- **Gender expression** : how one shows gender - dress, speech, mannerisms.
- **Sexual orientation** : to whom one is emotionally or physically attracted.
- **Gender role** : tasks & behaviour expected of each gender (cook, earn, care).
- **Gender stereotype** : fixed, over-simplified belief - "boys don't cry".
- **Patriarchy** : social system in which men hold power, authority and property.
- **Matriarchy or Matrilineal** : descent and inheritance through the mother (Khasi, Garo).
- **Gender discrimination** : unequal treatment on the ground of gender.
- **Gender equality** : equal rights, resources, opportunities & voice for all genders.
- **Gender equity** : fairness - giving each what they need to reach equality.
- **Transgender** : identity differs from the sex assigned at birth.
- **Gender sensitivity** : awareness of gender differences & inequalities and acting to remove them.



Remember (exam tip)

- Sex = Body, Gender identity = Mind, Expression = Dress, Behaviour, Orientation = Attraction.
- Equality = same for all; **Equity** = fair for each (different support, same outcome).

Q3. Distinguish between gender equality and gender equity.

Ans. Equality treats everyone identically; equity recognises different starting points and gives resources accordingly.

- Equality : same bicycle for all. Equity : bicycle that suits each rider's need.
- Aim of both : a society free of gender bias.

Q4. What is patriarchy? State its features.

Ans. A social order where men dominate women in family, work, law and religion.

- Male headship of family, inheritance through sons (patrilineal).
- Control over women's mobility, sexuality & labour.
- Preference for sons; dowry; the "honour" idea.

› Women are confined to the private (home) sphere, men to the public sphere.

3. Exploring Attitudes towards Gender

Attitudes are formed by family, school, peers, religion, media & law. They decide how we see "male" and "female".

Q5. How do attitudes towards gender develop?

Ans. Through repeated messages from childhood - "what a girl should or should not do".

› **Family** : toys (dolls for girls, cars for boys), chores, freedom of movement.

› **School** : textbooks show mother in kitchen, father at office, sports for boys.

› **Peers** : teasing of boys who cry, girls who are loud.

› **Media** : heroes = strong, heroines = beautiful & obedient.

› **Religion or custom** : rituals, fasting, who performs the last rites.

Q6. Give common gender-biased attitudes and the correct view.

Biased attitude	Correct or sensitive view
Boys are strong, they never cry	Emotions are human, not male or female
Girls are weak and need protection	Strength is individual; give girls skills & safety
Housework is women's duty	Care work is shared responsibility
Men are the breadwinners	Both can earn, both can care
Girls' education is a waste (she will marry)	Educated women uplift the whole family

Quick self-check questions

› Who does the cooking or cleaning in my house? Who takes decisions?

› Did I ever tell a boy "don't cry" or a girl "sit properly"?

› Recognising our own bias is the first step to becoming gender sensitive.

4. Construction of Gender

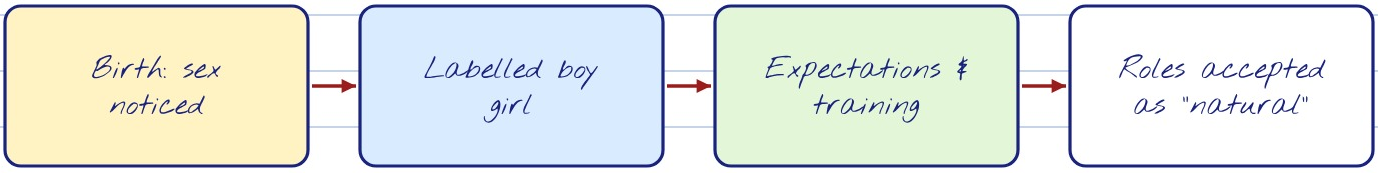
Social construction of gender : gender is not natural but "made" - through language, family, institutions and daily practice. Simone de Beauvoir : "One is not born, but rather becomes, a woman."

Q7. Explain how gender is socially constructed.

Ans. Society first notices a baby's sex and then assigns a full set of expectations.

› Naming, colour of clothes (pink or blue), toys, hairstyles, games.

- Division of tasks : girls help in kitchen, boys run errands outside.
- Language : "man of the house", "weaker sex", "tomboy" - words carry bias.
- Institutions (family, school, law, religion, market) **repeat** the pattern until it looks "natural".



Key points

- Gender is **learnt, performed and enforced** (rewards for conforming, punishment for deviating).
- Because it is constructed, it can be **de-constructed** and changed - this is the hope of gender studies.
- Gender intersects with caste, class, religion, region, disability.

Q8. What is the difference between biological determinism and social construction?

Biological determinism	Social construction
Roles follow from body (women nurture)	Roles follow from society & history
Differences are fixed	Differences are changeable
Used to justify inequality	Used to question inequality

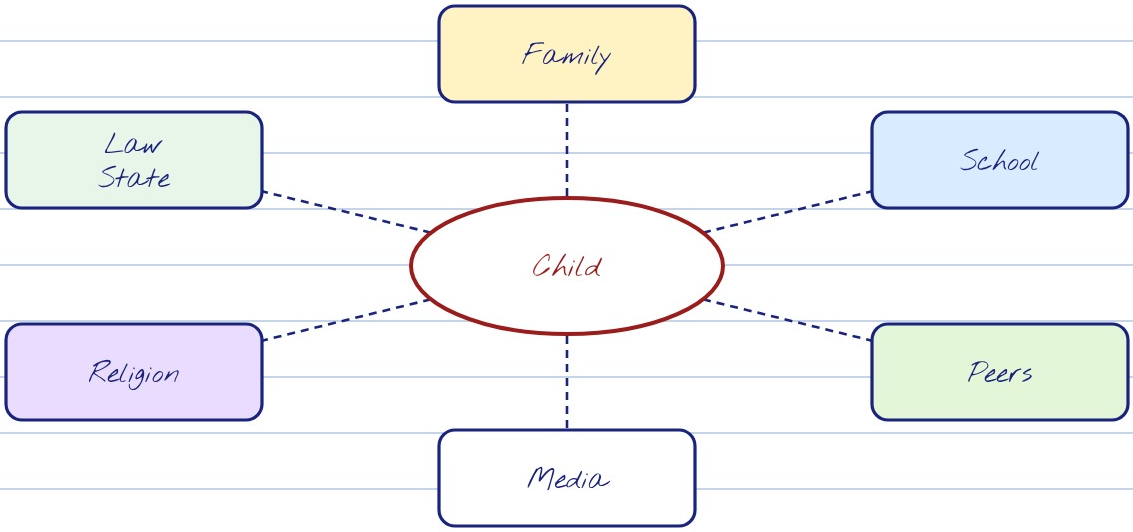
5. Socialization: Making Women, Making Men

Socialization = life-long process by which a person learns the values, norms, language and roles of his or her society. **Gender socialization** teaches a child how to be a "girl" or a "boy".

Q9. What is gender socialization? Name its agents.

Ans. It is the process of learning gender roles through interaction with agents of socialization.

- **Primary agent** : family (parents, siblings, grandparents).
- **Secondary agents** : school, peer group, religion, media, workplace, state.
- Methods : imitation, reward & punishment, instruction, role models.



Q10. Explain "Making Women, Making Men".

Ans. From birth, girls and boys are prepared for different futures.

- Girls : taught patience, modesty, obedience, care of others, household skills; their body is controlled ("don't go out after dark").
- Boys : taught courage, control, competition, earning; allowed freedom, anger, risk, outdoor play.
- Result : women become dependent, men become dominant - the **gender gap** is created.

Aspect	Girls are taught	Boys are taught
Behaviour	Be quiet, polite, adjust	Be bold, assertive, lead
Play	Dolls, kitchen set, skipping	Cars, cricket, guns
Work	Cook, clean, look after siblings	Run outside errands, earn
Emotion	Cry, show care	Hide feelings, be "tough"
Future	Marriage, motherhood	Career, provider

6. Preparing for Womanhood

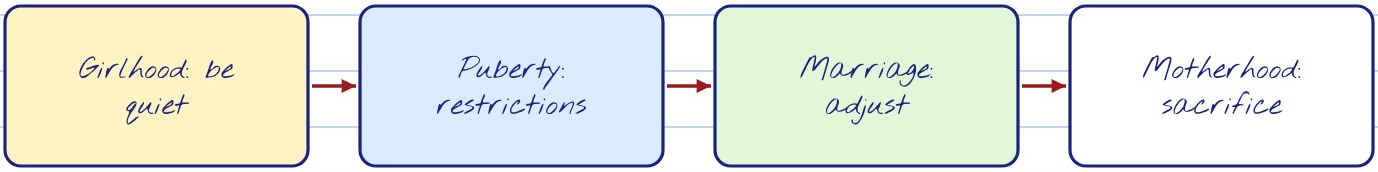
Theme (prescribed text) : how a girl is trained from childhood for the role of wife, daughter-in-law and mother - often at the cost of her education, mobility and dreams.

Q11. How is a girl child prepared for womanhood?

Ans. Through a series of lessons, spoken and unspoken, in the family and community.

- **Body discipline** : how to sit, walk, dress, laugh softly; menarche brings new restrictions & rituals.
- **Domestic training** : cooking, cleaning, sibling care - "practice for her husband's home".

- **Limited schooling** : early withdrawal, "girls are paraya dhan" (another's wealth).
- **Mobility control** : fear of "family honour", no night outings, accompanied travel.
- **Early marriage** & dowry thinking, identity as someone's daughter or wife or mother.



Impact on women

- Low self-esteem, lack of decision-making power, economic dependence.
- Health neglect (anaemia, early pregnancy), high drop-out of girls from school.
- Remedy : education, equal opportunity, laws (Prohibition of Child Marriage Act 2006), changing family attitudes.

7. Growing Up Male

Theme (prescribed text) : boys are also shaped - and pressed - by gender, "being a real man" has a heavy price.

Q12. How does a boy grow up as a male? What pressures does he face?

Ans. Boys learn that masculinity = power, control, no weakness.

- Encouraged to be aggressive, competitive & independent, "boys will be boys".
- Told "don't cry like a girl" - emotions suppressed -> anger, stress, silence.
- Freedom of space, time and money, no household duties -> later dependence on women's care.
- Pressure to earn, to protect, to dominate, fear of being teased as "weak".
- Peer groups reinforce **hyper-masculinity** (bullying, risk taking, harassment as "fun").

Privileges of boys	Costs of masculinity
Freedom, mobility, preference in education	Cannot show feelings, mental stress
Inheritance & decision power	Burden of being sole earner
Served at home	Violence, addiction, risk taking
Respect as the "head"	Isolation, fear of failure

Patriarchy hurts everyone - women are oppressed, men are pressed into narrow moulds.

Q13. Why is it important to include boys in gender discussions?

Ans. Equality cannot come unless men and boys change too.

- Sensitive boys become partners, not oppressors; share housework & care.
- Reduces violence, harassment and mental-health problems among men.

8. First Lessons in Caste

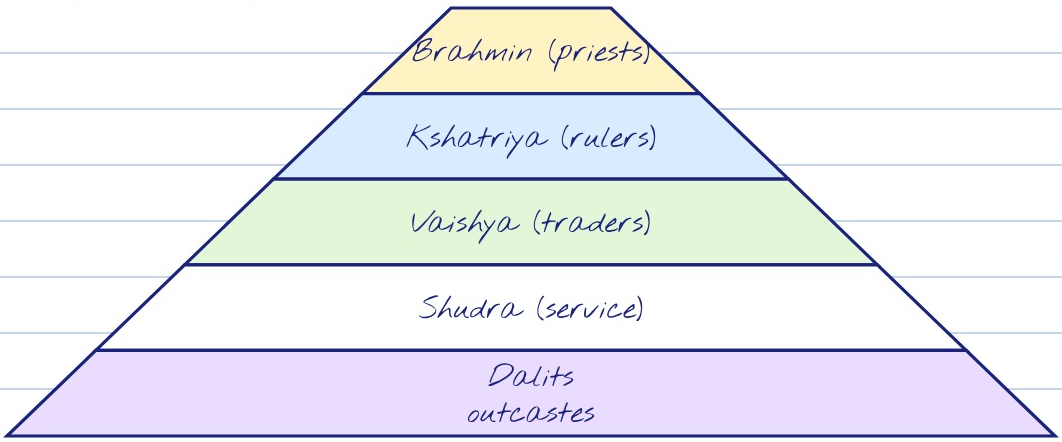
Theme (prescribed text) : a child meets caste early - in the village, school, temple, water source and the stories of the elders - and learns who is "high" and "low", who is "pure" and "impure".

Q14. What are the "first lessons in caste" learnt by a child?

Ans. Children absorb caste hierarchy through everyday life before they understand the word.

- Seating, food, water and games are divided on caste lines; "don't touch or don't eat with them".
- Separate settlements, wells, temples for Dalits; names and surnames reveal caste.
- Teachers & peers may humiliate lower-caste children; occupations are fixed by birth.
- Stories, proverbs & jokes teach superiority and inferiority.

Caste hierarchy (varna system)



Q15. How do caste and gender intersect?

Ans. Dalit women face **double (even triple) discrimination** - as women, as Dalits and as poor labourers.

- Upper-caste women : controlled sexuality to protect caste "purity" (endogamy, honour).
- Dalit women : sexual violence, manual scavenging, wage discrimination, denial of land.
- Hence, gender justice needs **intersectional** thinking (caste + class + gender).

Remedies or Constitutional safeguards

- Art. 14, 15, 16 (equality), Art. 17 (abolition of untouchability), Art. 21 (dignity).
- SC and ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act 1989; education, reservation; inter-caste dialogue.
- Social reformers : Jyotiba & Savitribai Phule, Dr. B.R. Ambedkar, Periyar.

9. More Important Questions

Q16. What is a gender stereotype? Give examples and effects.

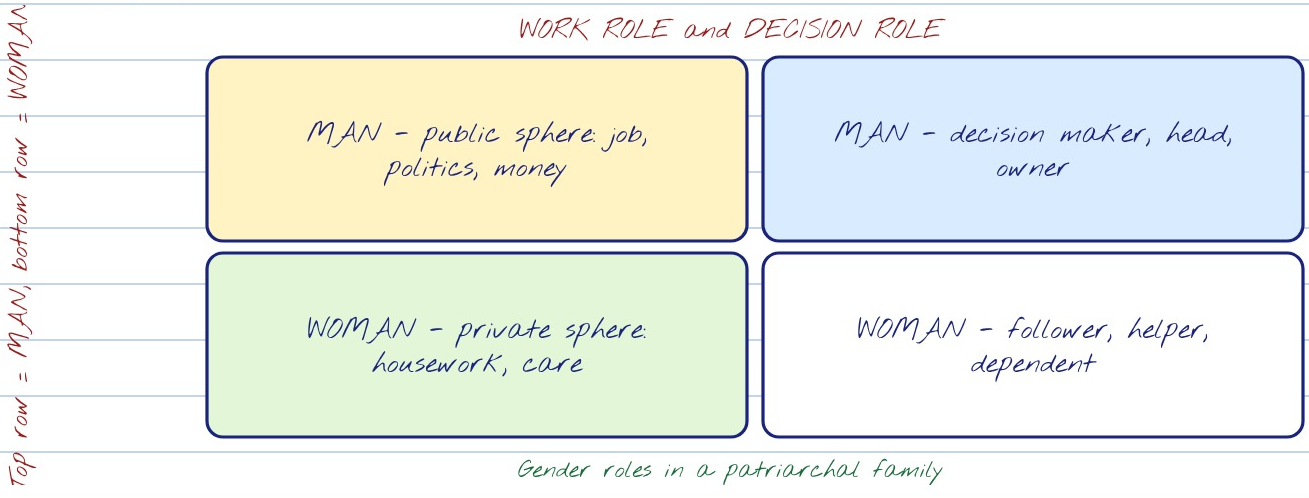
Ans. A fixed, generalised belief about how women and men should look, feel and behave.

- "Women are emotional, men are rational"; "girls are bad at maths"; "nursing is for women".
- Effects : limits choice of career, lowers confidence, justifies discrimination, hurts people who don't fit.
- Breaking stereotypes : role models, mixed-gender classrooms, balanced textbooks & media.

Stereotype about women	Stereotype about men
Gentle, emotional, dependent	Strong, rational, independent
Natural caregivers	Natural leaders or providers
Home-makers	Bread-winners
Should be modest	Should be dominant

Q17. Types of socialization - explain briefly.

- **Primary** : in early childhood, mainly in the family; language, basic values.
- **Secondary** : in school, peer group, workplace; wider norms.
- **Anticipatory** : learning for a future role (a girl rehearsing "bride" role).
- **Re-socialization** : unlearning old patterns, e.g. after marriage or a gender-training programme.



Gender roles in a patriarchal family

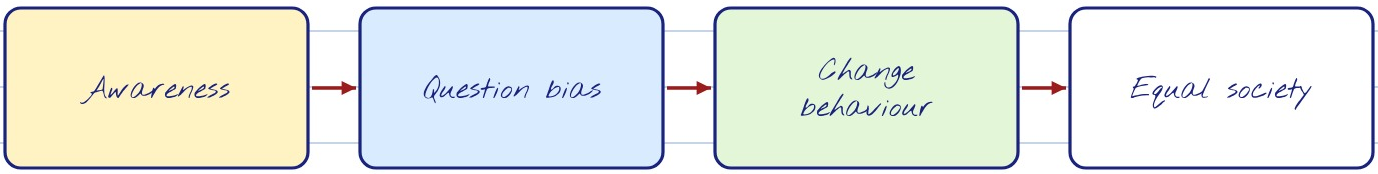
Q18. What is the role of education in gender sensitisation?

Ans. Education is the strongest tool to question and change gender norms.

- Gender-fair textbooks, co-education, equal sports & science opportunities for girls.
- Teachers trained to avoid bias, anti-harassment cells, life-skills & sex education.
- Educated girls : later marriage, healthier children, income, voice in decisions.

Q19. Why do we need gender sensitisation in colleges?

- Future engineers, managers & citizens must respect colleagues of all genders.
- Prevents ragging, eve-teasing, sexual harassment, builds a safe, inclusive campus.
- Improves teamwork and workplace culture.



Case study (practice)

- Rahul is mocked by friends for joining a dance class; his sister Rani is told to leave engineering as "girls should be teachers".
- Identify : stereotypes at work (boys don't dance, girls not for engineering).
- Suggest : support from parents/teachers, role models (male dancers, women engineers), equal opportunity.

10. Objective Practice (MCQs)

Q20. Choose the correct option

- 1. Gender is mainly : (a) biological **(b) social construct** (c) hormonal (d) fixed.
- 2. "One is not born, but becomes, a woman" was said by : (a) Mill **(b) Simone de Beauvoir** (c) Gandhi (d) Freud.
- 3. First & most important agent of socialization : **(a) family** (b) media (c) law (d) peers.
- 4. System in which men dominate : (a) matriarchy (b) democracy **(c) patriarchy** (d) feudalism.
- 5. Treating all alike (same support for all) = **equality**, fair, need-based support = **equity**.
- 6. Dalit women face : (a) single **(b) multiple discrimination** (c) none (d) only class bias.

11. Long Answer Questions (write in 10 marks format)

12. Short Answer Bank (Unit 1)

Q21. Write short notes

- **Gender role** : set of behaviours expected from a person because of being female or male.
- **Stereotype** : fixed over-simplified image, e.g. "women are emotional".
- **Intersex** : person born with sex characteristics that don't fit typical male or female.
- **Gender sensitisation** : training that increases awareness of gender bias & promotes equality.
- **Agents of socialization** : family, school, peers, media, religion.

Q22. Fill in the blanks or one-liners

- Gender is __ (socially constructed). Sex is __ (biological).
- "One is not born, but becomes, a woman" - ____ (Simone de Beauvoir).
- First agent of socialization = __ (family). System of male dominance = __ (patriarchy).

> Remember : Sex = born with, Gender = taught, Socialization = how it is taught.

UNIT 2

Gender Roles and Relations

two or many? • discrimination • roles • matrix • missing women • sex ratio • spectrum

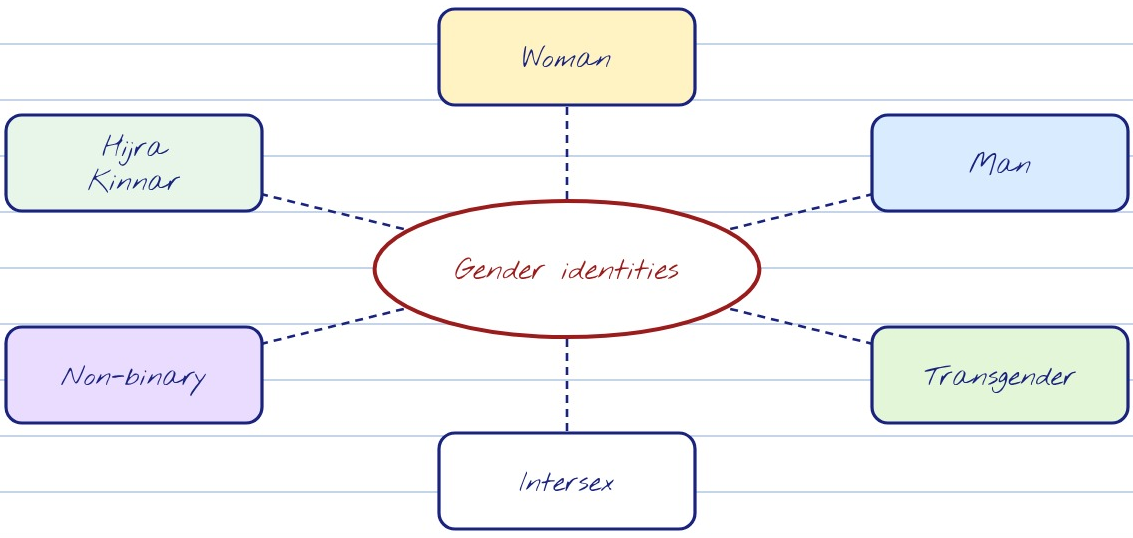
1. Two or Many? - The Gender Binary and Beyond

The **gender binary** is the belief that there are only two genders - man and woman - with fixed traits. Reality is wider: intersex persons, transgender persons, hijras, and many non-binary identities exist in every society and time.

Q1. Does gender have only two categories? Explain "Two or Many?".

Ans. No. Biologically sex is not always strictly two, and socially gender identity is a range.

- **Intersex** : born with chromosomes, hormones or organs that do not fit typical male or female.
- **Transgender** : gender identity differs from the sex assigned at birth (trans woman, trans man).
- **Hijra, Aravani, Kinnar, Jogta, Shiv-Shakti** : traditional third-gender communities of South Asia.
- **Non-binary or gender-queer or gender-fluid** : identify as neither or both or moving between.
- **Cisgender** : identity matches the sex assigned at birth.



Remember

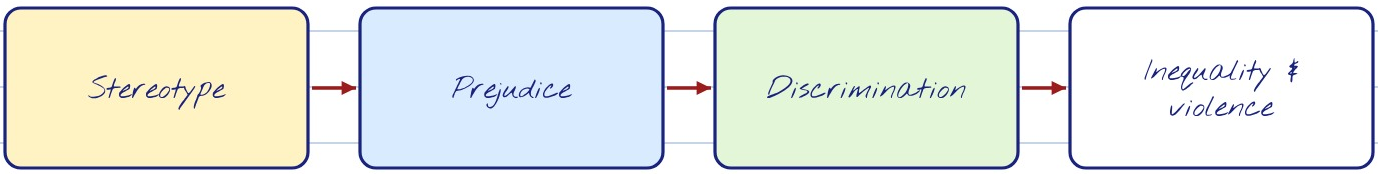
- Sex (body) is not the same as gender identity (mind) and sexual orientation (attraction).
- Third gender recognised by Supreme Court in **NALSA v. Union of India (2014)**; Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Act, 2019 gives right to self-perceived identity.

2. Struggles with Discrimination

Q2. What is gender discrimination? Where does it occur?

Ans. Unfair, unequal treatment or denial of opportunity to a person only on the ground of sex or gender.

- **Family** : son preference, unequal food, schooling & inheritance.
- **Education** : drop-out of girls, "boys' subjects".
- **Work** : wage gap, glass ceiling, unsafe workplaces, no promotion after maternity.
- **Public life** : low political representation, street harassment.
- **Law and custom** : personal laws, property, guardianship, honour codes.



Q3. Describe the struggles of women, transgender persons and others against discrimination.

- **Women's movements** : Savitribai Phule (girls' education), Raja Ram Mohan Roy (against sati), Pandita Ramabai, Begum Rokeya, Tarabai Shinde; later Chipko, Anti-dowry, Shah Bano and Mathura rape case campaigns, Me Too.
- **Law reform** : Hindu Succession (Amendment) Act 2005 - equal coparcenary right to daughters; Equal Remuneration Act 1976.
- **Transgender struggle** : recognition (NALSA 2014), end of criminalisation of same-sex relations (Navtej Singh Johar, 2018), welfare boards.
- **Global** : suffragettes, CEDAW (1979), Beijing Conference (1995).

Year	Milestone
1848	Seneca Falls Convention (USA) - women's rights
1979	CEDAW adopted by UN General Assembly
1993	India ratifies CEDAW; DEVAW declaration
1995	Beijing Platform for Action
2005	Daughters get equal coparcenary right (Hindu Succession Act)
2014	NALSA judgment - third gender
2018	Navtej Singh Johar - Sec. 377 read down

3. Gender Roles and Relations

Gender roles = behaviours, tasks and responsibilities a society expects from women and men. **Gender relations** = the power relations between them - who controls resources, decisions, time and body.

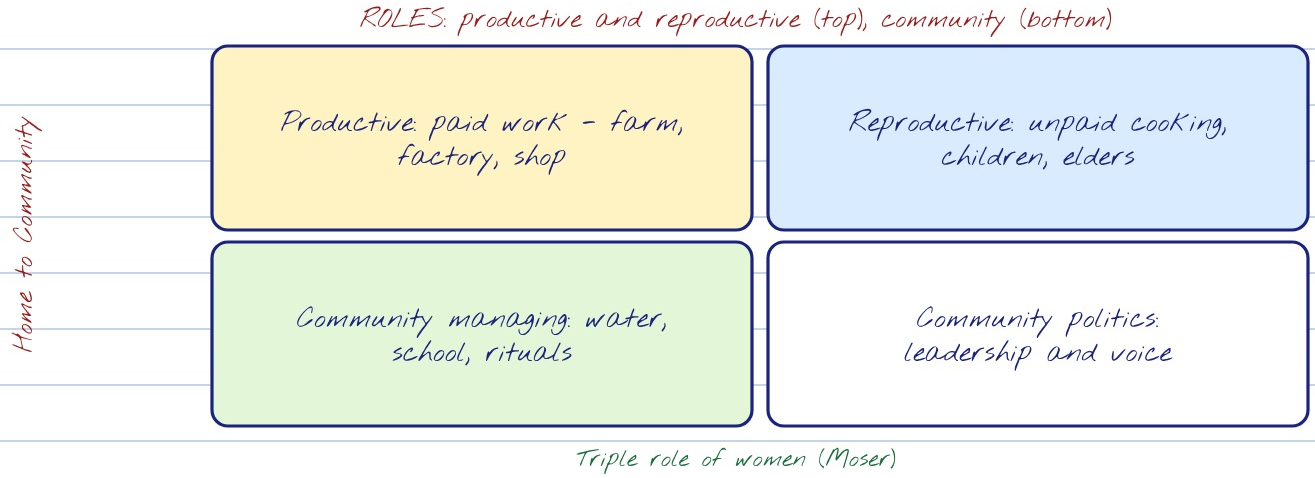
Q4. Define gender roles and gender relations. How are they different?

Gender roles	Gender relations
What women and men DO	How women and men RELATE (power)
Division of tasks	Access to and control over resources
Can be changed or swapped	Rooted in patriarchy, hard to change
Example : women cook, men earn	Example : men decide how income is spent

Q5. Explain the types of gender roles (Moser's triple role).

Ans. Caroline Moser described three kinds of work done by women and men.

- **Productive role** : work for pay or in kind - farming, factory, business (valued, counted).
- **Reproductive role** : childbearing, child-rearing, cooking, cleaning, care of old (unpaid, invisible).
- **Community managing role** : unpaid work to maintain community resources - water, health camps, festivals (mostly women).
- **Community politics role** : formal leadership, decision making, panchayat, party (mostly men).



Triple role of women (Moser)

Role categories at a glance

- **Traditional roles** : fixed by custom (women = homemakers, men = providers).
- **Modern roles** : shared - both earn, both care.
- **Reversed roles** : house-husbands, women breadwinners; show that roles are not "natural".
- **Role conflict** : working women carry the **double burden** (job + housework).

4. Gender Roles and Relationships Matrix

A **matrix** (like Harvard Analytical Framework) is a tool to record WHO does WHAT, who has ACCESS to and CONTROL over resources in a family or community.

Q6. What is the gender roles and relationships matrix? Draw and explain.

Ans. It maps activities, resources and decisions by gender to spot imbalance before planning a programme.

Activity or Resource	Women	Men	Access	Control
Cooking, cleaning, child care	Yes	Rare	Women	Women (low value)
Farm work, wage labour	Yes	Yes	Both	Men
Land, house, bank account	No	Yes	Men	Men
Mobile phone, vehicle	Limited	Yes	Men	Men
Community meetings, panchayat	Few	Many	Men	Men
Household income decisions	Few	Yes	Men	Men

- **Access** = can use a resource; **Control** = can decide about it and own it.
- Women often have access (they use) but no control (they don't decide).
- Use : planners design projects so that benefits reach women and decision power is shared.

5. Missing Women

Q7. What is meant by "Missing Women"?

Ans. Term of Nobel economist **Amartya Sen (1990)** : the number of women who should have been alive had they received equal care but are "missing" because of neglect, selective abortion and infanticide.

- In nature, more boys are born (~105 per 100 girls) but women live longer, so females should be slightly more.
- In India and China the ratio is lower - tens of millions of women "missing".
- Causes : female foeticide, infanticide, neglect in food, health care and education, dowry deaths, maternal mortality, violence.

Missing women = Expected women - Actual women alive

6. Sex Selection and its Consequences

Q8. What is sex selection? Why does it happen?

Ans. Choosing the sex of a child before birth (pre-conception, pre-natal) or after birth (infanticide) - nearly always in favour of boys.

- **Son preference** : sons seen as heirs, old-age support, performers of last rites; daughters as "burden" (dowry, safety).
- Easy availability of ultrasound, small-family norm, patriarchy, poor enforcement of law.

Q9. What are the consequences of sex selection?

- Skewed sex ratio, shortage of brides -> forced marriage, bride trafficking, polyandry in some regions.
- More violence, sexual crimes, insecurity for girls, early marriage.
- Social problems : male surplus, loneliness, crime; harms women's health (repeated abortions).
- Long-term demographic imbalance.

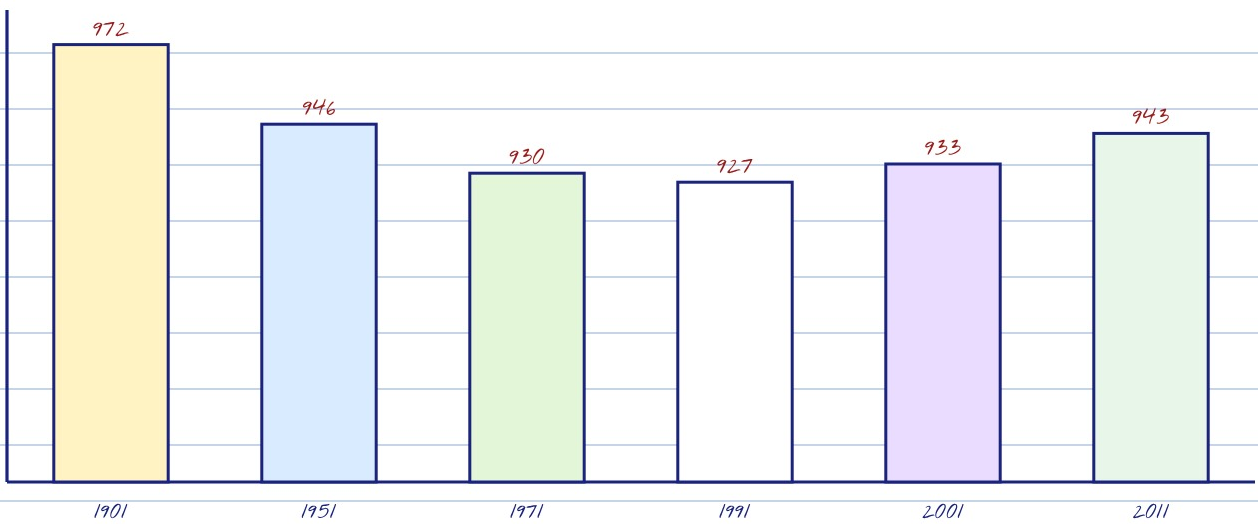
Laws and schemes against sex selection

- **PCPNDT Act, 1994** (amended 2003) : bans sex determination tests, advertisements; punishment to doctors and parents.
- MTP Act 1971 (amended 2021) : abortion only for specified reasons, not for sex.
- **Beti Bachao Beti Padhao** (2015), Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana, Ladli, Kanyashree schemes.

7. Declining Sex Ratio

Sex ratio = number of females per 1000 males. **Child sex ratio (CSR)** = females per 1000 males in age group 0-6 years.

India sex ratio (females per 1000 males, Census) (scale starts above zero)



Q10. What is the trend of child sex ratio in India?

Ans. CSR fell from 927 (Census 2001) to 919 (Census 2011) - the lowest since Independence, despite overall sex ratio improving.

- Lowest CSR states (2011) : Haryana, Punjab, Delhi, Chandigarh; best overall sex ratio : Kerala (1084); high CSR : Mizoram, Chhattisgarh.

› Reasons : sex-selective abortion, higher female infant mortality, neglect, migration of men.

8. Demographic Consequences

Q11. Explain the demographic consequences of a declining sex ratio.

› **Marriage squeeze** : fewer women of marriageable age, bride import from other regions, bride price.

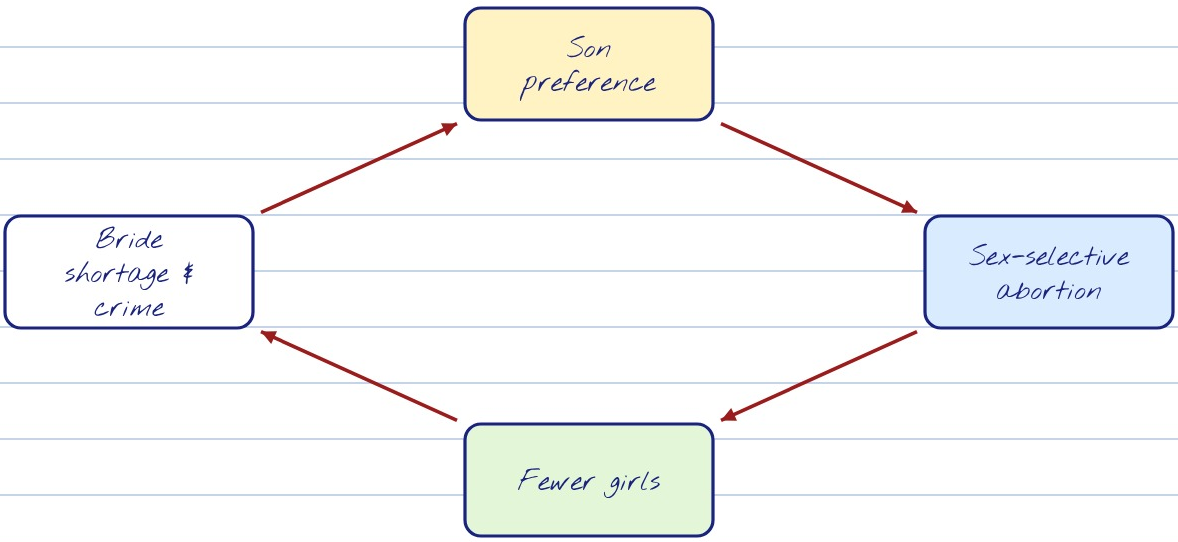
› **Increase in crimes** : trafficking, kidnapping, harassment, sexual violence.

› **Change of family structure** : late marriage of men, more single men, ageing without care.

› **Social unrest** : competition, aggression, weak community ties.

› **Impact on population growth** : fewer mothers -> falling birth rate in future.

› **Violation of right to life** of girls (Art. 21, CEDAW).



Way forward

› Strict implementation of PCPNDT, awareness campaigns, community watch.

› Equal inheritance, end dowry, economic security for women (old-age support by daughters).

› Education, positive media images, incentives for girl child.

9. The Gender Spectrum

Gender spectrum : gender is a continuum rather than two boxes - people can sit anywhere along it, move across it, or reject labels altogether.

Q12. Explain the gender spectrum and why it is important.

Ans. It shows that masculinity and femininity are not opposite ends of one line but traits available to all.

- Gender identity (who I am), expression (how I show it), assigned sex (body) and attraction are **four separate dimensions.**
- Recognising the spectrum ends stigma, supports transgender and queer persons and widens freedom for everyone.

Term	Meaning
Cisgender	Identity matches sex assigned at birth
Transgender	Identity differs from sex at birth
Non-binary	Not exclusively man or woman
Gender-fluid	Identity changes over time
Gender dysphoria	Distress when body and identity differ
Queer	Umbrella term for non-heteronormative identities

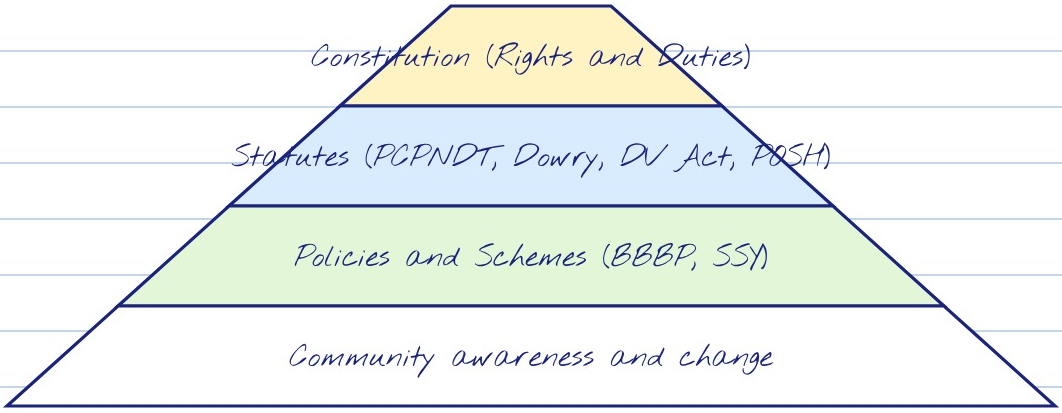
Q13. Mention Key rights of transgender persons in India.

- Right to self-perceived gender identity; certificate of identity (Act of 2019).
- No discrimination in education, employment, health, housing; welfare board and special measures.
- Offences : forced begging, denial of access to public places, physical or sexual abuse are punishable.

10. Constitutional and Legal Provisions for Gender Equality

Q14. List constitutional provisions that support gender equality in India.

Article	Provision
Art. 14	Equality before law, equal protection of laws
Art. 15(1), 15(3)	No discrimination on sex, special provisions for women and children
Art. 16	Equal opportunity in public employment
Art. 21	Right to life with dignity (includes privacy, safety)
Art. 39(a), (d)	Adequate livelihood, equal pay for equal work (DPSP)
Art. 42	Just and humane work conditions, maternity relief
Art. 51A(e)	Fundamental duty : renounce practices derogatory to women
Art. 243D, 243T	One-third seats for women in Panchayats and Municipalities



Q15. What is the difference between sex ratio and child sex ratio? Why is CSR more alarming?

Ans. Sex ratio counts all ages; CSR counts only children 0-6 years, so it shows the direct effect of sex selection at birth.

- Overall sex ratio can rise because women live longer, hiding the problem; CSR falling means fewer girls are even born.

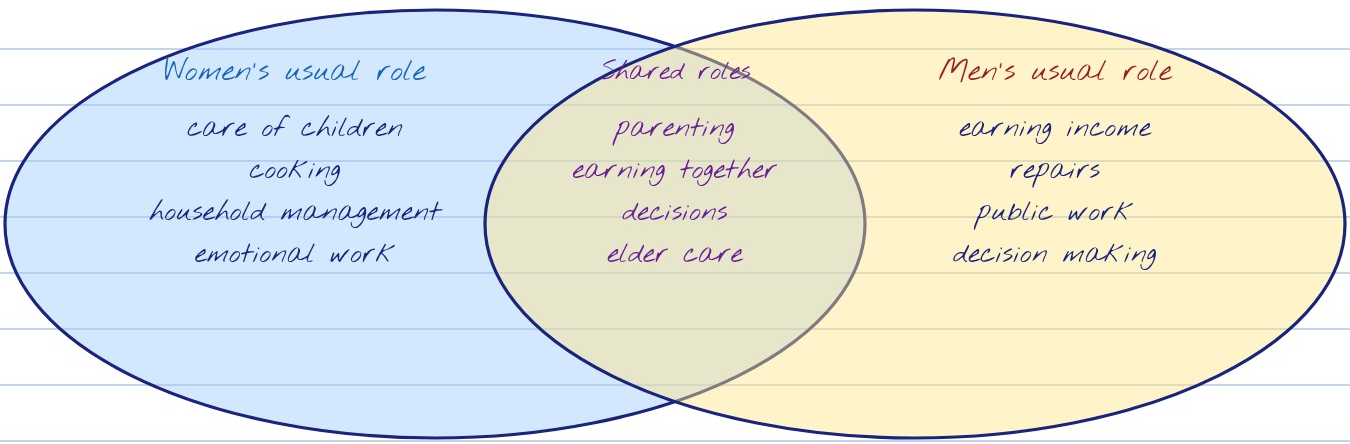
II. Case Study and Discussion

Case study : "Only a son"

- Sunita has two daughters. Her in-laws pressure her for a third child and ask a clinic for a scan to check the sex.
- Identify : son preference, patriarchy, illegal sex determination (PCPNDT), violation of her bodily autonomy.
- Suggest : inform the Appropriate Authority, counselling, awareness that daughters can also be heirs and caregivers, schemes for girl child.

Q16. How do gender roles hurt men too?

- Men must be provider and protector; those who cry, care or stay at home are ridiculed.
- Higher rates of stress, addiction, suicide and risky behaviour; less time with children.
- Rigid roles limit everyone; sharing roles gives a happier, equal family.



12. Objective and Long Questions

Q17. Quick choice

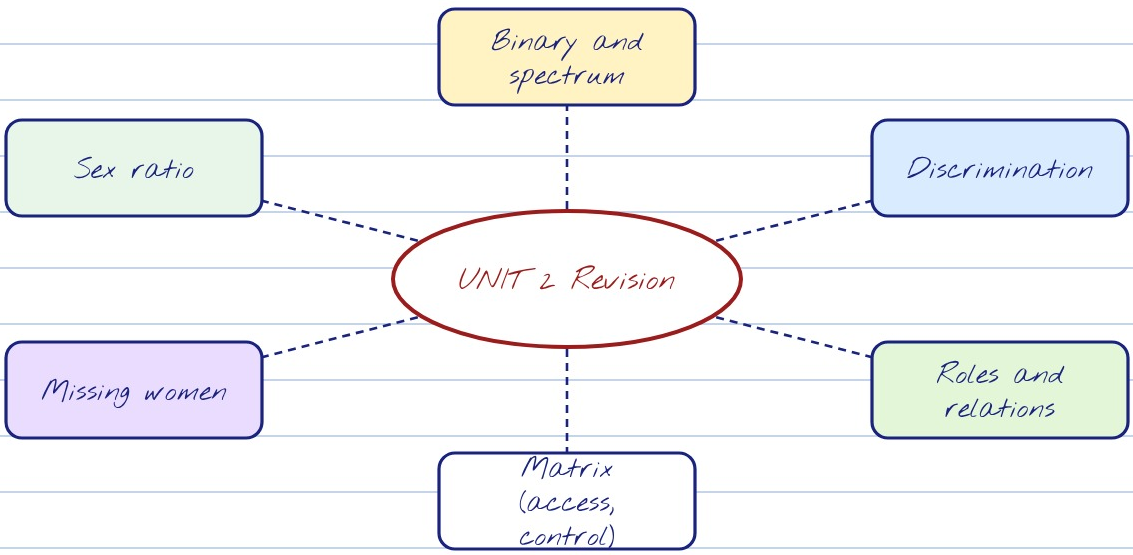
> 1. Female per 1000 male = **sex ratio**. 2. "Missing women" – **Amartya Sen**.
> 3. PCPNDT Act year = **1994**. 4. CSR 2011 = **919**. 5. Third gender recognised in **NALSA (2014)**.
> 6. Unpaid cooking & caring = **reproductive role**.

Q18. Long answers (10 marks)

> 1. Discuss "Two or Many?" and the gender spectrum. (Sec. 1, 9)
> 2. Explain types of gender roles and the roles-relationship matrix. (Sec. 3, 4)
> 3. Causes, consequences and remedies of sex selection and declining sex ratio. (Sec. 5–8)
> 4. Describe struggles against gender discrimination in India. (Sec. 2)

Gender roles can be changed – gender relations must be made EQUAL.

13. Two-Mark Questions and Quick Revision



Q19. Two-mark questions

> 1. **Gender relations** : power relations between women and men in access to resources and decisions.
> 2. **Productive role** : paid or income-generating work; **reproductive role** : unpaid care and housework.
> 3. **Sex ratio** : females per 1000 males; **CSR** : in age 0–6 years.
> 4. **Missing women** : women lost due to neglect, selective abortion, infanticide (Amartya Sen).
> 5. **Intersex** : born with sex traits not fitting male or female boxes.
> 6. **Glass ceiling** : invisible barrier stopping women from reaching top positions.
> 7. **Double burden** : paid job plus unpaid housework done by women.

> 8. **PCPNDT Act** : bans pre-natal sex determination and sex-selective abortion.

Concept	One-line memory aid
Roles	What we DO (can swap)
Relations	Who has POWER (must equalise)
Access vs Control	Use vs Decide
Spectrum	Many positions, not two boxes

UNIT 3

Gender and Labour

division of labour • housework • unpaid work • development • governance • rights • mainstreaming

1. Division and Valuation of Labour

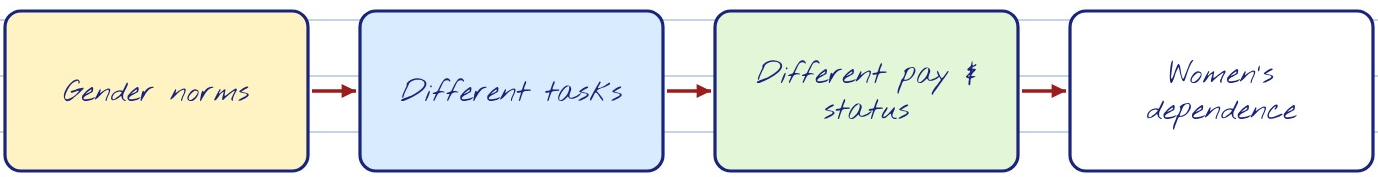
Sexual (gender) division of labour = allocation of different tasks to women and men on the basis of gender, not skill. Tasks done by men are usually **paid, public and valued**, tasks done by women are **unpaid, private and undervalued**.

Q1. Explain the gender division of labour and the valuation of work.

Ans. Society splits work into "productive" (earning) and "reproductive" (caring) and then values them unequally.

- Women do most of cooking, cleaning, child care, elder care, fetching water and fuel.
- Men do most paid work outside, are considered "workers" and "heads".
- Women's work in farms, family business and home is called "help", not work.
- **Same work, different pay** : women get lower wages and are concentrated in low-paid, insecure jobs (domestic work, beedi rolling, agriculture labour).

Type of work	Mostly done by	Valued as
Paid job, business	Men	Productive, respected
Housework and care	Women	"Natural duty", no pay
Farm work on family land	Women and men	Women = "helper"
Domestic help, nursing	Women	Low-paid "women's jobs"



Key terms

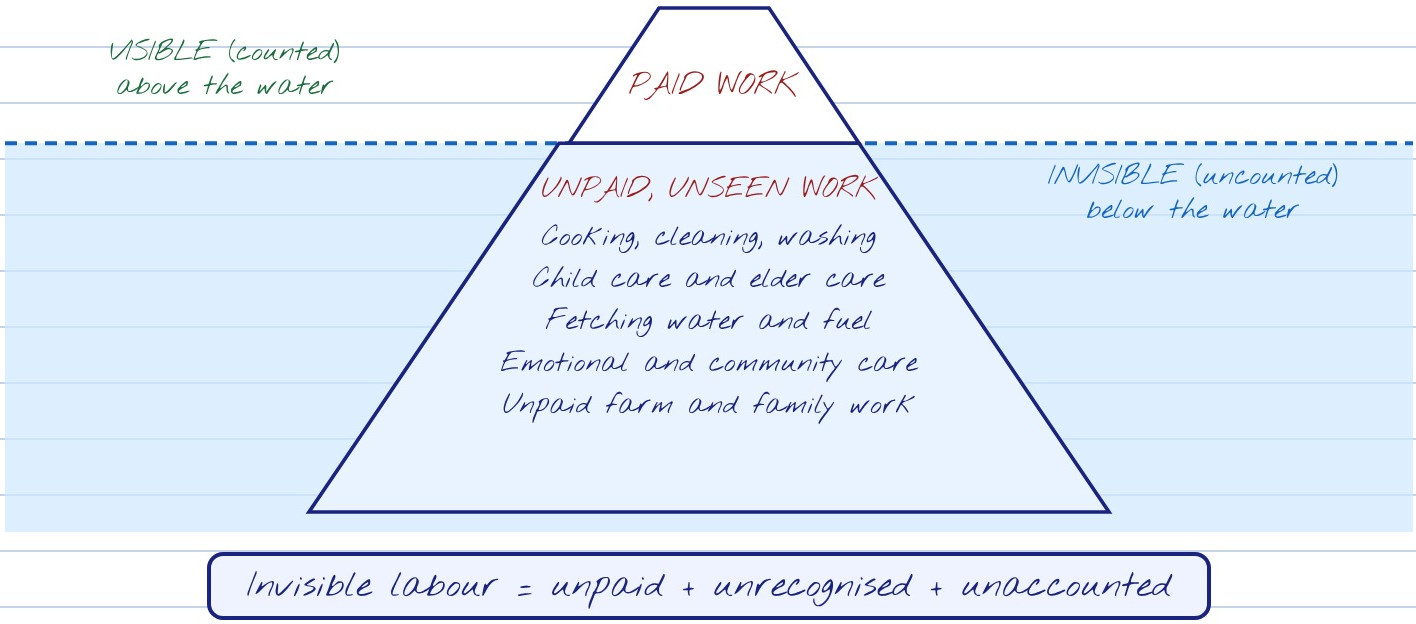
- **Horizontal segregation** : women crowded in certain jobs (teaching, nursing, garment).
- **Vertical segregation** : women at lower levels - the **glass ceiling** blocks top posts.
- **Feminisation of labour** : women entering insecure, informal, low-wage work.
- **Gender wage gap** : women earn less than men for equal work.

2. Housework: The Invisible Labour

Q2. Why is housework called "invisible labour"?

Ans. Because it is unpaid, unrecorded in GDP, assumed to be women's love and duty, and done inside the home.

- Includes : cooking, cleaning, washing, child and elder care, shopping, managing the family, emotional care.
- Takes **long hours** (women spend several times more time on unpaid domestic work than men - Time Use Survey 2019).
- Leaves women **time-poor** : less time for education, paid jobs, rest, politics.
- Economic value is huge but not counted in national income.



Invisible labour = unpaid + unrecognised + unaccounted

3. "My Mother Doesn't Work."

Theme (textbook essay) : when asked "does your mother work?", children say "No, she is a housewife" - though she works from dawn to night. This shows how society defines **work = paid employment**.

Q3. Discuss the statement "My mother doesn't work."

Ans. It reflects the belief that only income-earning activity is work, so homemakers' labour becomes invisible and valueless.

- Mother's daily work : cooking, cleaning, care of children, elders, animals, guests - 12 to 16 hours.
- Because she gets no wage, she is seen as dependent and "not working".
- Census and surveys earlier classed housewives as "non-workers" or "dependants".
- **Lesson** : redefine work to include care work; give dignity, respect and economic recognition.

What recognition can look like

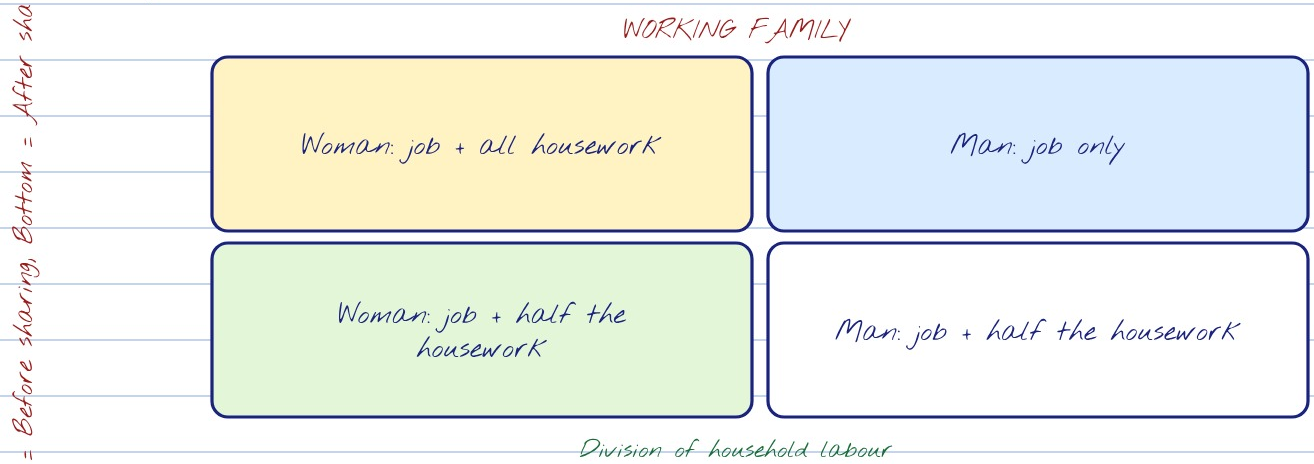
- Counting unpaid work in time-use surveys and satellite accounts of GDP.
- Social security, pension and health cover for homemakers.
- Respect and shared decisions at home, equal property rights.

4. "Share the Load."

Q4. What is meant by "Share the Load"? Why is it needed?

Ans. A call for men and boys to share housework and care equally so that the burden does not fall only on women.

- Working women face the **double burden** (job + home) or **triple burden** (+ community).
- Sharing improves women's health, career, leisure and equality; children learn respect.
- Men gain closer bonds with children and family and are freed from the "sole provider" pressure.



Q5. How can the load be shared? (Practical steps)

- Teach boys and girls the same life skills (cooking, cleaning, care).
- Make a family roster of daily chores, use technology and shared services.
- Paternity leave, flexible work, creches at workplace, change attitudes ("helping" -> "responsibility").

5. Work: Its Politics and Economics - Fact and Fiction

Q6. Explain the politics and economics of work. Distinguish fact and fiction.

Ans. **Economics** : who is paid, how much, and what counts in GDP. **Politics** : who has the power to define work, set wages and control resources.

Fiction (myth)	Fact
Women's work is only supplementary income	Women are often main or sole earners
Women don't want to work outside	Lack of safe jobs, creches, transport and family support
Women are less productive	Equal output, they face career breaks and bias
Housework is not real work	It sustains the economy; value is huge
Men are always the breadwinners	Many women-headed households exist

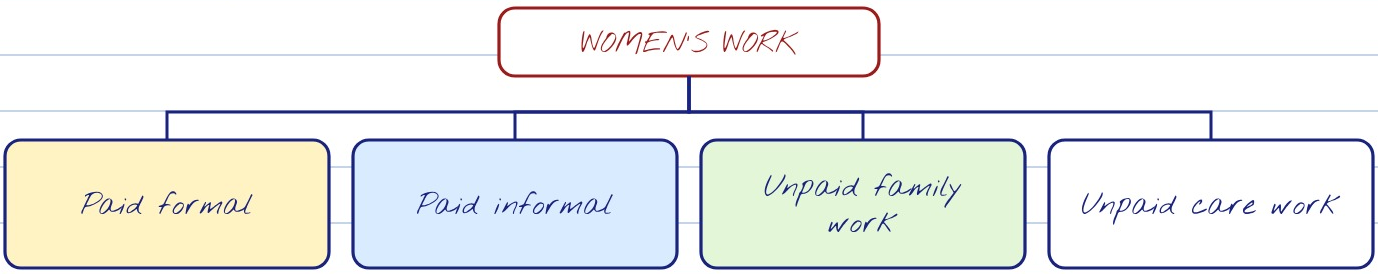
- Most women work in the **informal sector** (agriculture, domestic work, home-based) with no contract, no social security.
- National income accounts ignore unpaid work -> women's contribution is under-estimated.
- Equal pay is legally guaranteed (Equal Remuneration Act 1976, now Code on Wages 2019) but gaps persist.

6. Unrecognised and Unaccounted Work

Q7. What is unrecognised and unaccounted work? Give examples.

Ans. Work that is done but not recognised as work in law or society (unrecognised) and not included in national statistics (unaccounted).

- Housework, child and elder care, volunteer community service.
- Unpaid labour on family farm or in family shop, collecting fuel, fodder and water.
- Home-based piece-rate work (beedi, agarbatti, embroidery) counted as "hobby".
- Subsistence production, Kitchen gardens, rearing livestock.



Recommendations

- Time-use surveys (India's first national Time Use Survey 2019), satellite accounts.
- Registration of home-based and domestic workers, minimum wages, social security.
- Maternity Benefit (Amendment) Act 2017 : 26 weeks paid leave, creche for 50 or more employees.

7. Gender Development Issues

Q8. What are the main gender development issues? Name the gender indices.

Ans. Gender gaps in education, health, income, work and power slow human development.

- **Education** : lower female literacy, drop-outs, fewer girls in STEM.
- **Health** : anaemia, maternal mortality, low nutrition, unequal care.
- **Economic** : low workforce participation, wage gap, no land or asset ownership.
- **Political** : under-representation in legislatures and leadership.
- **Safety** : violence, trafficking, harassment.

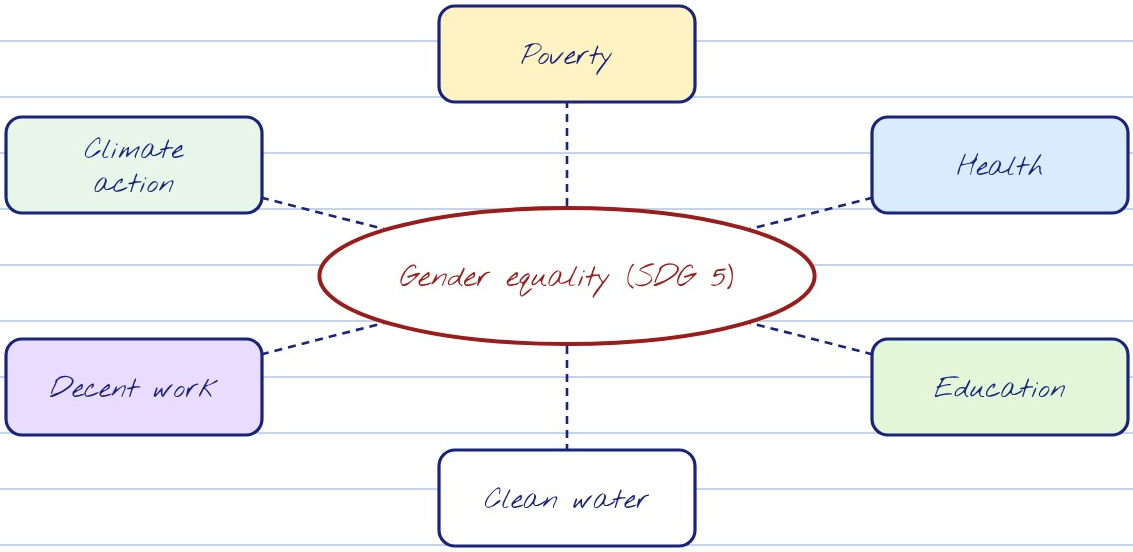
Index	Full form and what it measures
HDI	Human Development Index – health, education, income
GDI	Gender Development Index – HDI gap between women and men
GII	Gender Inequality Index – reproductive health, empowerment, labour market
GEM	Gender Empowerment Measure – political and economic participation
Global Gender Gap Index	World Economic Forum – economy, education, health, politics

8. Gender, Governance and Sustainable Development

Q9. How are gender, governance and sustainable development related?

Ans. Good governance needs equal participation of women; sustainable development is impossible without gender equality (**SDG 5**).

- **Governance** : women in decision-making make policies sensitive to health, water, school, safety.
- 73rd and 74th Amendments (1992–93) : 33 per cent (now 50 per cent in many states) seats in Panchayats and Municipalities.
- **Women's Reservation Act, 2023 (Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam)** : one-third seats for women in Lok Sabha and State Assemblies.
- **Sustainability** : women manage water, forests, seeds and food; Chipko, Green Belt movement.
- Gender budgeting and gender audits make public money reach women.



9. Gender and Human Rights

Q10. Explain gender and human rights. Mention important instruments.

Ans. Women's rights are human rights - universal, indivisible, equal.

- **UDHR 1948** : all human beings are born free and equal.
- **CEDAW 1979** : "Bill of Rights for Women"; India ratified in 1993.
- **Vienna Declaration 1993** : women's rights are inseparable part of human rights.
- **DEVAW 1993** : UN Declaration on Elimination of Violence against Women.
- **Beijing Platform for Action 1995** : 12 critical areas, mainstreaming.
- In India : Fundamental Rights (Art. 14, 15, 21), Directive Principles, special laws.

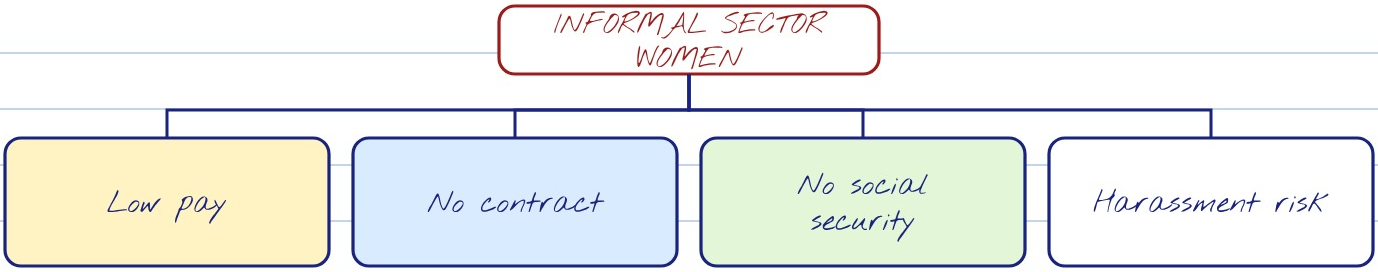
10. Women in the Labour Force: Informal Sector

Q11. Describe the position of women workers in the informal sector.

Ans. Most working women in India are in the unorganised sector - agriculture, construction, domestic work, home-based work, street vending - with low pay and no protection.

- No written contract, no fixed hours, no paid leave, no pension or maternity cover.
- Often paid piece-rate and less than men; unsafe work places; sexual harassment.
- Domestic workers : long hours, no weekly off, low wages, abuse; recent laws and welfare boards try to protect them.

- Self-help groups (SEWA, Kudumbashree, SHGs) organise women for credit, skills and voice.



Legal protections for working women

- Equal Remuneration Act 1976 and Code on Wages 2019 : equal pay for equal or similar work.
- Maternity Benefit Act 1961 (2017 amendment) : 26 weeks leave, creche, work from home option.
- Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace Act (POSH) 2013 : Internal Committee.
- Factories Act : safety, restrictions on night shifts only with safeguards.
- Unorganised Workers Social Security Act 2008; Domestic workers welfare schemes.

Q12. What is gender budgeting?

Ans. Analysis of government budgets to see their effect on women and men and allocating funds to close gaps.

- Started in India 2005-06 : Gender Budget Statement, Gender Budget Cells in ministries.
- Part A : schemes 100 per cent for women; Part B : at least 30 per cent for women.

Q13. Case study - "Meena, a domestic worker"

- Works 10 hours in four houses, paid below minimum wage, no leave, and does her own housework at night.
- Identify : informal sector, double burden, invisible work, wage gap.
- Suggest : registration and minimum wage, weekly off, social security, shared housework at her home, union support.

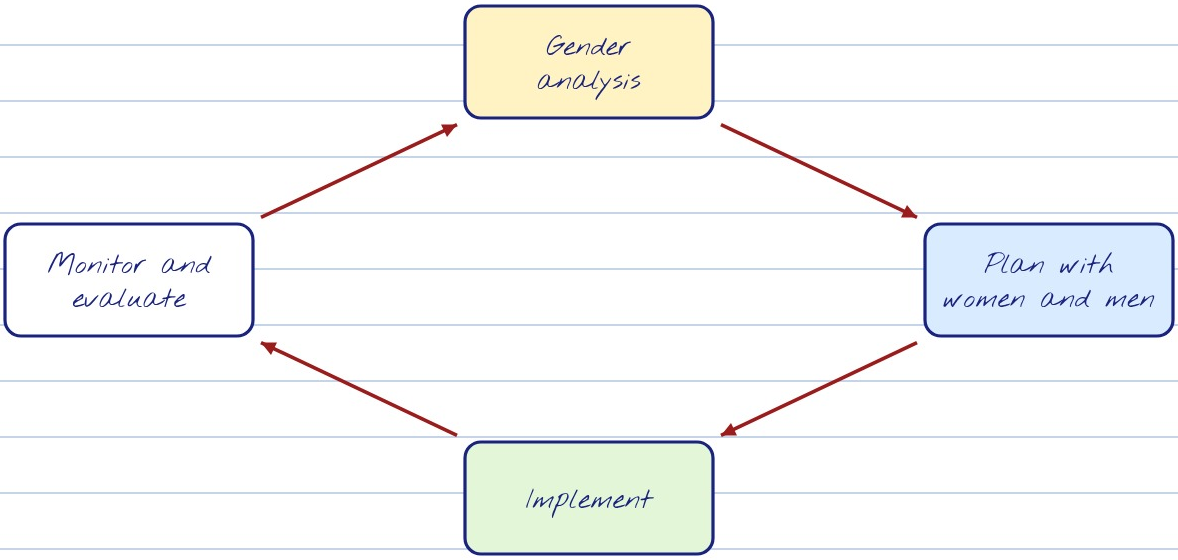
II. Gender Mainstreaming

Q14. What is gender mainstreaming? State its strategies.

Ans. ECOSOC (1997) : the process of assessing implications for women and men of any planned action, law, policy or programme, and making women's and men's concerns an integral dimension of all spheres so that **inequality is not perpetuated**.

- Gender analysis of every policy, budget and project before it is made.

- Gender budgeting, gender-disaggregated data, sex-wise targets.
- Gender focal points, training of officials, women's participation at all levels.
- Complement with **women-specific programmes** (twin-track approach).



Women-specific	Mainstreaming
Targets women only	Integrates gender in all policies
Special schemes (e.g. SHGs)	Gender lens on roads, energy, health, IT
Short term	Long term, systemic

12. Objective and Long Questions

Q15. Quick recall

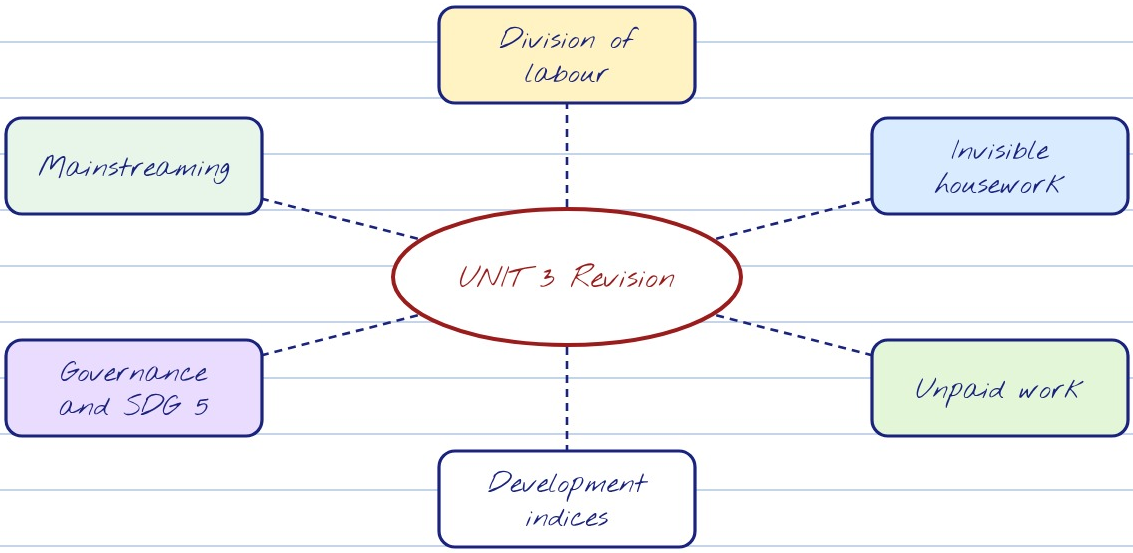
- 1. Unpaid household work is called **invisible labour**. 2. Glass ceiling = **vertical segregation**.
- 3. CEDAW adopted = **1979**. 4. India ratified CEDAW = **1993**. 5. SDG for gender equality = **SDG 5**.
- 6. Mainstreaming defined by **ECOSOC (1997)**. 7. Maternity leave now = **26 weeks**.

Q16. Long answers

- 1. Explain division and valuation of labour with examples. (Sec. 1)
- 2. Housework as invisible labour, discuss "My Mother Doesn't Work" and "Share the Load". (Sec. 2-4)
- 3. Unrecognised and unaccounted work; politics and economics of work. (Sec. 5, 6, 10)
- 4. Gender, governance, sustainable development, human rights and mainstreaming. (Sec. 8-11)

What is not counted does not count - make care work visible, valued and shared.

13. Two-Mark Questions and Quick Revision



Q17. Two-mark questions

> 1. **Gender division of labour** : tasks assigned to women and men on the basis of gender.
> 2. **Double burden** : paid work plus unpaid household work.
> 3. **Informal sector** : work without contract, social security or legal protection.
> 4. **Glass ceiling** : invisible barrier to promotion of women.
> 5. **Gender budgeting** : analysing budgets for their effect on women and men.
> 6. **GII** : Gender Inequality Index (health, empowerment, labour market).
> 7. **Mainstreaming** : bringing a gender perspective into all policies and programmes.
> 8. **Twin-track approach** : mainstreaming plus women-specific programmes.

Concept	One-line memory aid
Productive work	Paid, counted, valued
Reproductive work	Unpaid, uncounted, undervalued
Mainstreaming	Gender lens on EVERY policy
SDG 5	Gender equality and empowerment

UNIT 4

Gender-Based Violence

concept • types • human rights • harassment • domestic violence • causes • impact

1. The Concept of Violence

Violence = the intentional use of physical force, power, threat or coercion against a person or group that results in, or is likely to result in, injury, psychological harm, deprivation or death (WHO).

Gender-based violence (GBV) = any harmful act directed at a person **because of their gender** or that affects one gender disproportionately. The UN **DEVAW (1993)** defines violence against women as "any act of gender-based violence that results in physical, sexual or psychological harm or suffering to women, including threats, coercion or arbitrary deprivation of liberty, whether in public or private life."

Q1. Define violence and gender-based violence. What are its key features?

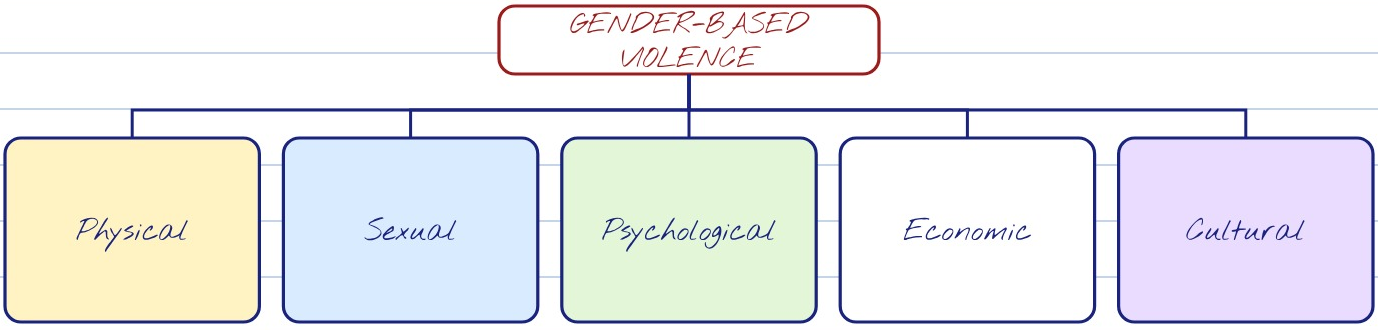
- Rooted in **unequal power relations** between women and men (patriarchy).
- Happens in **private** (home) and **public** (street, workplace, online) spaces.
- Often **normalised** or blamed on the victim; under-reported due to shame, fear, dependence.
- Victims are mostly women, girls and sexual minorities; men and boys can also be victims.
- Perpetrators : partner, family member, acquaintance, employer, stranger, even the state.

GBV = violence + gender inequality + power and control

2. Types of Gender-Based Violence

Q2. Explain the types of gender-based violence.

- **Physical** : hitting, slapping, burning, acid attack, murder, forced abortion.
- **Sexual** : rape, marital rape, molestation, sexual harassment, forced prostitution, trafficking.
- **Psychological or emotional** : insults, threats, isolation, constant control, stalking.
- **Economic** : denying money, taking salary, preventing work or property rights.
- **Structural or cultural** : female foeticide, child marriage, dowry, honour killing, witch-hunting, FGM (global), denial of education.
- **Digital or cyber** : online trolling, morphing, non-consensual image sharing, cyber-stalking.



Type	Examples
Physical	Beating, burning, acid attack
Sexual	Rape, groping, harassment, trafficking
Emotional	Abuse, threats, isolation, stalking
Economic	Control of money, no property, no job
Cultural	Dowry, child marriage, honour killing, foeticide
Cyber	Trolling, morphing, doxxing, revenge porn

Across a woman's life cycle

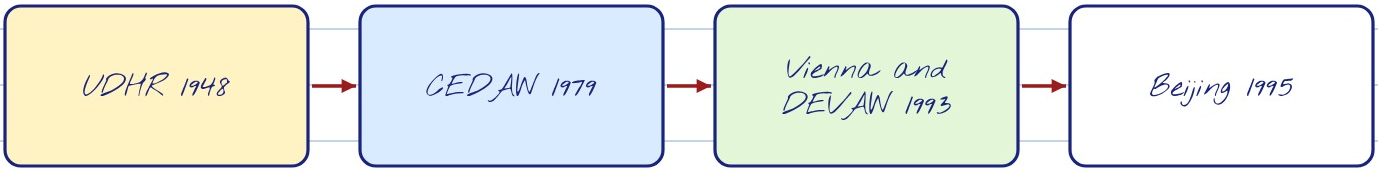
- **Before birth** : sex-selective abortion. **Infancy** : infanticide, neglect. **Girlhood** : child marriage, abuse, less food and school.
- **Adolescence** : eve-teasing, trafficking, acid attacks. **Adulthood** : domestic violence, rape, dowry harassment. **Old age** : abandonment, witch-branding, elder abuse.

3. Gender-Based Violence from a Human Rights Perspective

Q3. Why is violence against women a human rights violation?

Ans. It denies women the right to life, liberty, equality, dignity, bodily integrity and freedom from torture and discrimination - rights guaranteed to every person.

- **UDHR 1948** Art. 1-3, 5 : equality, life, security, no cruel treatment.
- **CEDAW 1979** and General Recommendation 19 (1992) : GBV is discrimination.
- **Vienna Conference 1993** : "Women's rights are human rights"; **DEVAW 1993**.
- **Beijing 1995** : violence against women is a critical area of concern.
- **State responsibility** : to prevent, investigate, punish and give remedy (**due diligence**) - even for acts by private persons.
- **India** : Art. 14, 15, 21 (right to live with dignity); judgments like **Vishaka (1997)**, **Nirbhaya reforms (2013)**.



Human-rights approach means

- Victim is a **rights-holder**, not a "problem" or "shame of family".
- State and society must **prevent, protect, prosecute, provide** (4 Ps).
- Focus on **consent**, dignity, equality and justice rather than "honour".

4. Sexual Harassment

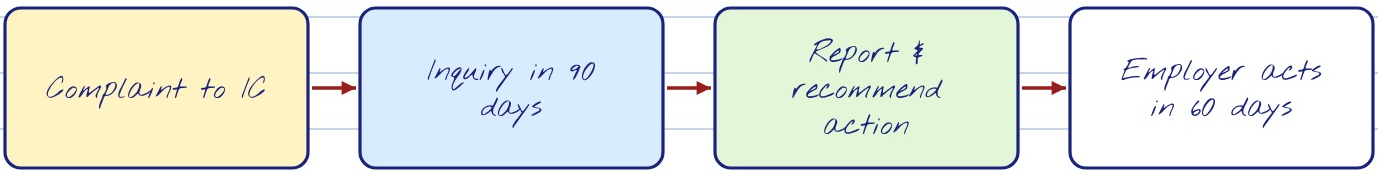
Q4. What is sexual harassment? Explain its forms.

Ans. Unwelcome sexual behaviour (physical, verbal or non-verbal) that offends or humiliates, creating a hostile or intimidating environment.

- **Physical** : unwanted touch, pinching, blocking the way, forced contact.
- **Verbal** : sexual jokes, comments on body, repeated proposals, obscene calls.
- **Non-verbal** : staring, gestures, showing porn, stalking, online messages.
- **Quid pro quo** : demand for sexual favour in return for job, grade or promotion.
- **Hostile environment** : posters, remarks or behaviour that make the workplace unsafe.

Q5. Explain legal provisions on sexual harassment in India.

- **Vishaka v. State of Rajasthan (1997)** : Supreme Court laid down guidelines for workplaces (origin: Bhanwari Devi case).
- **POSH Act, 2013** (Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace - Prevention, Prohibition, Redressal) : every office with 10 or more employees must form an **Internal Committee (IC)**; Local Committee at district level.
- Complaint within **3 months** (extendable); inquiry within 90 days; action under service rules; penalty on employer for non-compliance.
- Criminal law : BNS (earlier IPC 354A-D) - sexual harassment, assault, voyeurism, stalking.
- Colleges : UGC regulations on prevention of sexual harassment, anti-ragging cells.



What to do if harassed

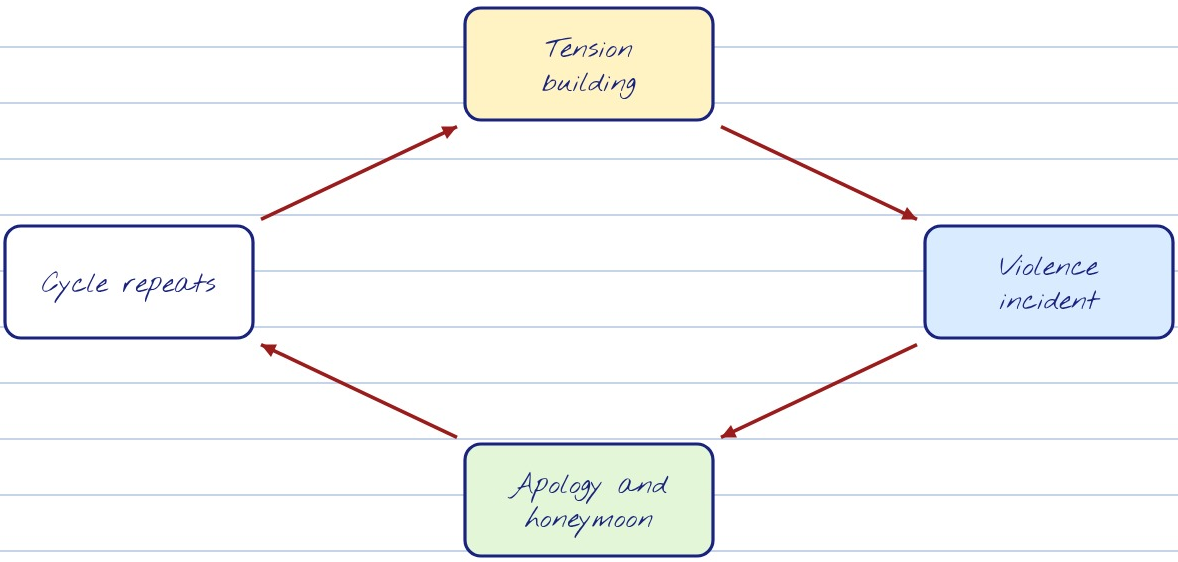
- Say NO clearly; Keep evidence (messages, dates, witnesses); report to IC, ICC, or police; seek support from friends and helplines.
- Bystanders : intervene safely, support the survivor, do not blame.

5. Domestic Violence

Q6. What is domestic violence? Explain the Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act, 2005.

Ans. Violence by a partner or family member within the household - physical, sexual, verbal, emotional and economic abuse, including dowry harassment.

- **PWDVA 2005** covers women in a domestic relationship (wife, live-in partner, sister, mother) and gives **civil remedies**.
- **Reliefs** : protection order, residence order (right to live in shared household), monetary relief, custody of children, compensation.
- **Protection Officers** and service providers (shelter homes, medical facilities, legal aid), the Magistrate hears the case.
- Also : Section 498A IPC (now BNS s. 85) - cruelty by husband or relatives; **Dowry Prohibition Act, 1961**; dowry death (BNS s. 80).



Q7. Explain the cycle of violence (Lenore Walker).

- **Tension building** : arguments, threats, victim "walks on eggshells".
- **Acute violence** : beating, abuse.
- **Reconciliation or honeymoon** : apology, gifts, promises, blaming stress - victim hopes it will end.
- The cycle repeats and becomes more severe -> learned helplessness, it is hard to leave because of children, money, fear and social pressure.

6. Different Forms of Violence against Women

Form	Brief description
Female foeticide and infanticide	Killing of girl child before or after birth
Child marriage	Marriage below 18 years (Prohibition of Child Marriage Act 2006)
Dowry harassment and death	Demands for money or goods; cruelty; death within 7 years of marriage
Honour Killing	Killing for marrying outside caste or religion or against family wish
Acid attack	Throwing acid; IPC 326A (BNS s. 124) – 10 years to life
Rape and gang rape	Criminal Law (Amendment) Act 2013 after the Nirbhaya case (2012)
Trafficking	Selling women and girls for sex or labour (ITPA 1956)
Stalking and cyber crime	Following, repeated calls, morphing, trolling
Witch-hunting	Branding vulnerable women as witches; torture
Marital rape	Not yet an offence in India for adult wives (debated in courts)
Female genital cutting	Practised in parts of Africa, Asia (Bohra community debate in India)

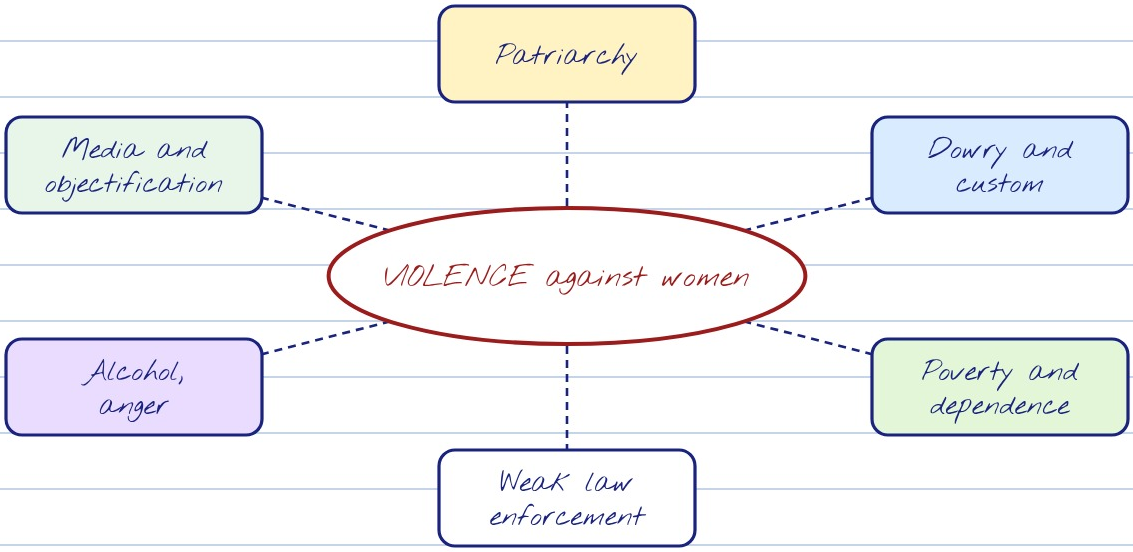
Q8. Mention some remedies and helplines.

- **181** Women Helpline, **112** Emergency, **1091** Women in distress, **1098** Childline, **1930** cyber crime (cybercrime.gov.in).
- One-Stop Centres (Sakhi), All Women Police Stations, Fast-Track courts, NCW, State Women Commissions.

7. Causes of Violence against Women

Q9. Discuss the causes of violence against women.

- **Patriarchy** : male control and ideas of ownership over women's bodies and lives.
- **Socio-cultural** : dowry, son preference, "honour", stereotypes, silence on abuse, victim-blaming.
- **Economic** : women's dependence, poverty, lack of property and jobs.
- **Legal and institutional** : slow justice, poor police response, weak implementation, low conviction.
- **Psychological** : power, anger, addiction (alcohol, drugs), learned violence in childhood.
- **Media** : objectification, glorified aggression, pornography.
- **Education gap** : lack of gender sensitisation and respect for consent.



8. Impact of Violence against Women

Q10. Explain the impact of violence on women, families and society.

Level	Impact
Physical	Injuries, disability, chronic pain, STIs, unwanted pregnancy, death
Psychological	Fear, depression, anxiety, PTSD, low self-esteem, suicidal thoughts
Social	Isolation, stigma, school or job loss, restricted mobility
Economic	Medical cost, lost wages, lost productivity, poverty
Family and children	Children witnessing abuse suffer trauma and may repeat violence
Society and nation	Lost human potential, high health and legal cost, slow development

9. Consequences of Gender-Based Violence

Q11. What are the consequences of gender-based violence and how can it be eliminated?

- **For the survivor** : trauma, ill health, fear, silence, loss of freedom, sometimes death or suicide.
- **For the community** : fear culture, fewer girls in school and jobs, normalised crime, weakened trust.
- **For the nation** : cost to economy and health system; violation of constitutional values; poor Gender Inequality Index.

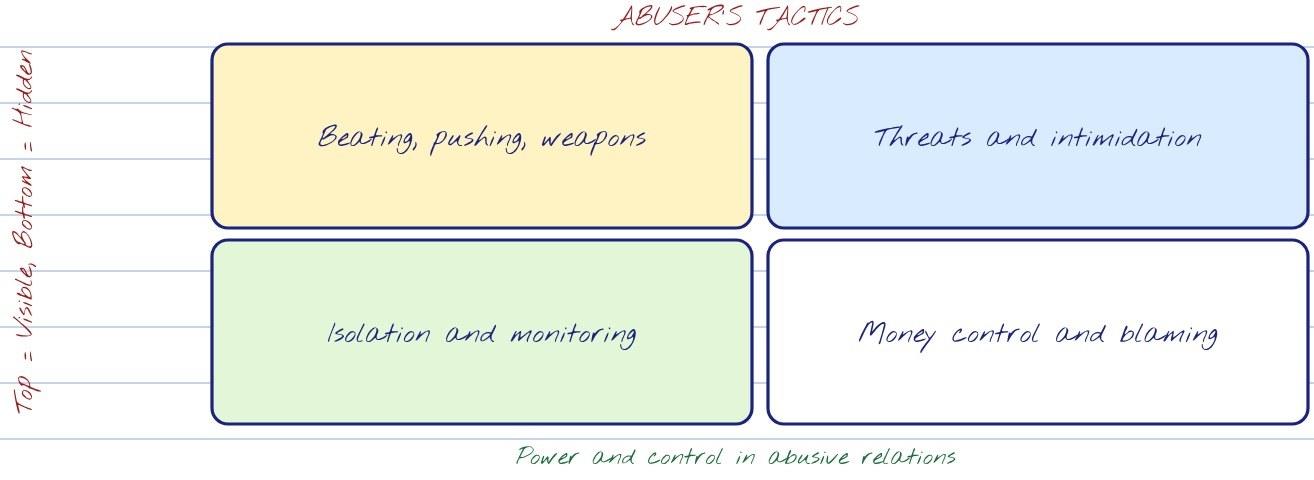
Measures to end GBV

- **Education** : gender sensitisation in school and college, teach consent and respect, engage men and boys.
- **Legal** : strict implementation, fast-track courts, police sensitisation, witness protection.
- **Economic** : jobs, property rights, skills for women's independence.
- **Social** : community vigilance, SHGs, break silence, support survivors; **16 Days of Activism** (25 Nov – 10 Dec), White Ribbon campaign.

10. Myths and Facts about Gender-Based Violence

Q12. Distinguish myths and facts about violence against women.

Myth	Fact
Violence happens only to poor, uneducated women	It happens in every class, caste, religion and education level
Women provoke it by dress or behaviour	The only cause of violence is the abuser's choice
Domestic violence is a private family matter	It is a crime and a human-rights violation
Strangers commit most rapes	Most offenders are known to the survivor
Men are never victims	Men, boys and transgender persons also face GBV, though women are the majority
A woman who stays must like it	Fear, children, money and shame trap survivors



11. Criminal Law Reforms and Institutions

Q13. Write about the Nirbhaya case and Criminal Law (Amendment) Act, 2013.

Ans. After the brutal gang rape in Delhi (Dec 2012), the **Justice Verma Committee** recommended reforms.

- Wider definition of rape, new offences - acid attack, stalking, voyeurism, sexual harassment, trafficking.
- Higher punishment (up to death in rarest cases for rape causing death or vegetative state).
- Later : Criminal Law (Amendment) Act 2018 - death penalty for rape of girls below 12; POCSO Act 2012 protects children below 18.
- Now codified in **Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) 2023**.

Institution	Role
National Commission for Women (NCW, 1992)	Reviews laws, investigates complaints, advises government
State Women Commissions	Same role at state level
One-Stop Centre (Sakhi)	Medical, police, legal, counselling help under one roof
Mahila Police Stations	Women-friendly policing
Protection Officers	Help under DV Act 2005
Fast-track courts	Speedy trial of sexual offences

Case study : "Priya at the workplace"

- Priya's manager sends late-night messages and hints that her promotion depends on "being friendly". She feels afraid.
- Identify : quid pro quo sexual harassment (POSH Act).
- Steps : Keep proof, say NO in writing, complain to Internal Committee within 3 months, seek support, employer must act.

12. Objective and Long Questions

Q14. Quick recall

- 1. DEVAW adopted in **1993**. 2. Vishaka guidelines **1997**. 3. POSH Act **2013** (IC for 10+ staff).
- 4. PWDVA **2005**. 5. Women's helpline **181**; emergency **112**. 6. Cycle of violence - **Lenore Walker**.
- 7. Economic abuse = control of money, work and property.

Q15. Long answers

- 1. Concept, types and forms of gender-based violence. (Sec. 1, 2, 6)
- 2. GBV from a human-rights perspective. (Sec. 3)
- 3. Sexual harassment and the POSH Act, 2013. (Sec. 4)
- 4. Domestic violence and PWDVA 2005; cycle of violence. (Sec. 5)
- 5. Causes, impact and consequences of violence against women; suggest remedies. (Sec. 7-9)

Violence is never the victim's fault - believe, support, act.

UNIT 5

Gender and Culture

film • media • advertisement • literature • gender issues • language • relationships

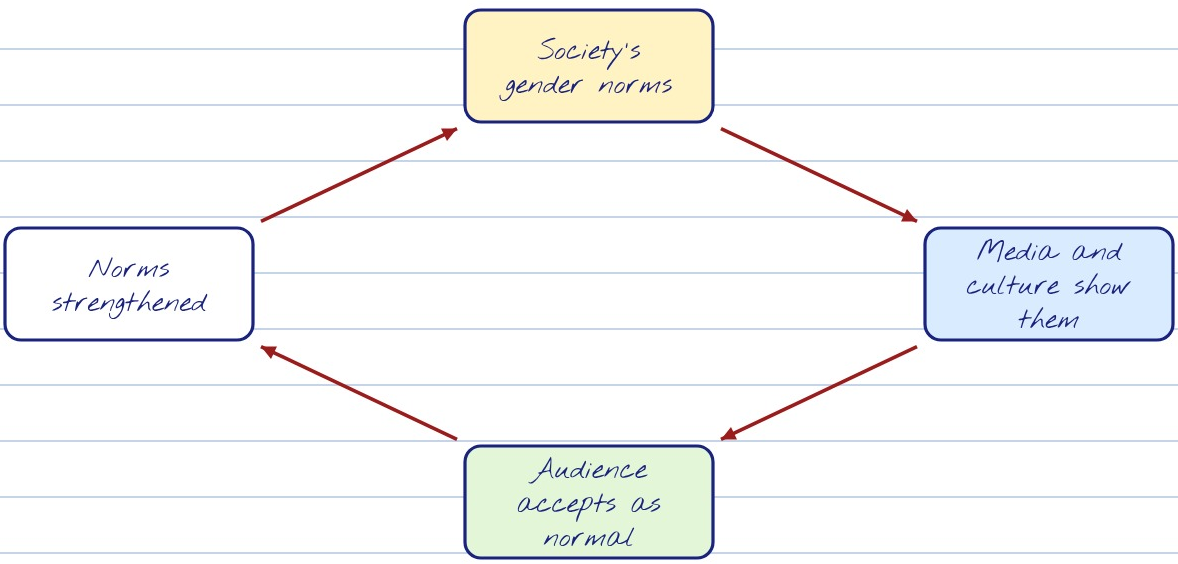
1. Gender and Culture: Introduction

Culture = shared values, beliefs, customs, art, language and media of a society. Culture **shapes** our ideas of "masculine" and "feminine", and in turn media and art **reflect and reinforce** those ideas.

Q1. How are gender and culture related?

Ans. Culture decides what is "proper" for men and women; popular culture (films, TV, ads, books, songs, social media) repeats these ideas daily until they look natural.

- Culture can **reproduce** stereotypes (obedient heroine, aggressive hero).
- It can also **challenge** them through feminist films, women writers, campaigns.



Key idea

- Media is a mirror (reflects society) and a hammer (shapes society). Learn to read it critically = **media literacy**.

2. Gender and Film

Q2. How are women and men represented in films?

Ans. Mainstream cinema often shows women as objects of desire, sacrificing mothers, ideal wives or vamps, and men as strong heroes, saviours and rescuers.

- **Women** : decorative roles, item songs, passive romantic interest, victim to be rescued, "good vs bad woman" binary.
- **Men** : hyper-masculine action heroes, violent, stalking shown as romance ("no means yes").

- **Behind camera** : very few women directors, writers, cinematographers - **male gaze** (Laura Mulvey, 1975).
- **Positive change** : women-centred films, strong female leads, parallel and regional cinema (e.g., Mother India, Arth, Mirch Masala, Queen, Thappad, Kahaani, Dangal, Chak De India), trans and queer stories now appearing.

Traditional portrayal	Progressive portrayal
Woman = bride, mother, sacrifice	Woman = individual with goals
Hero rescues heroine	Women rescue themselves, partners support
Stalking, harassment = "romance"	Consent and respect = love
Item song, body display	Dignity, varied body types and ages
Male lead drives plot	Women-led narratives

Bechdel Test (Alison Bechdel, 1985)

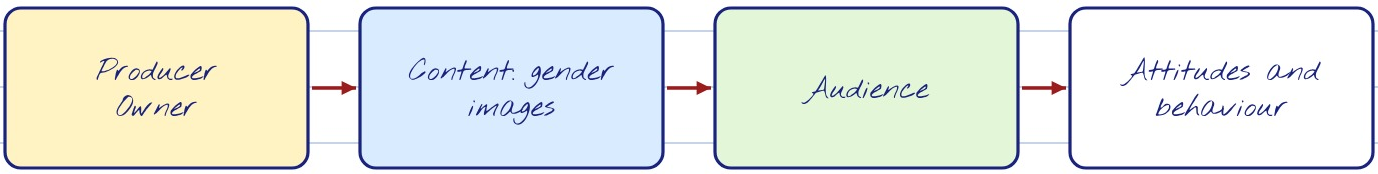
- Does a film (1) have at least two named women, (2) who talk to each other, (3) about something other than a man?
- Many popular films fail; the test is a simple check of women's presence in stories.

3. Gender and Electronic Media

Q3. Discuss the role of electronic media (TV, radio, internet, social media) in shaping gender.

Ans. Electronic media reaches millions daily and strongly influences attitudes of children and adults.

- **Television serials** : women as scheming, weepy or self-sacrificing; family and marriage-centred stories.
- **News** : fewer women experts and anchors in serious news; crimes reported in sensational or victim-blaming style.
- **Reality shows and music videos** : objectification and stereotypes.
- **Internet and social media** : empowering (voice, campaigns like #MeToo, #HeForShe, #BringBackOurGirls) but also **trolling, cyber-stalking, morphing, body shaming.**
- **Gaming and OTT** : male-dominated worlds; improving with diverse characters.



Positive uses

- Awareness campaigns, helplines, women's radio (community radio), online education and e-commerce for women entrepreneurs.
- Safe-use skills : privacy settings, reporting, cyber-law (IT Act 2000 s. 66E, 67; cybercrime portal 1930).

4. Gender and Advertisement

Q4. How do advertisements portray gender? Discuss the issues.

Ans. Advertising sells products by selling images - and often sells gender stereotypes too.

- **Women** : housewives promoting cleaning, kitchen and food products; "perfect" fair, slim body for beauty products; used as sex objects to sell cars, perfumes, tyres.
- **Men** : strong, tough, earning, rarely seen doing housework or care.
- **Children** : pink for girls (dolls), blue for boys (cars).
- **Issues** : objectification, body image problems, colour bias (fairness creams), unrealistic beauty, reinforcing unequal division of labour.

Product type	Typical gender image
Detergent, kitchen, food	Woman as cook-cleaner
Cars, bikes, finance	Man as driver-earner
Beauty and fairness creams	Woman must please by looks
Toys	Girls = dolls, boys = machines
Deodorants, razors	Male power, female attraction

Q5. What laws and codes control indecent or sexist advertising?

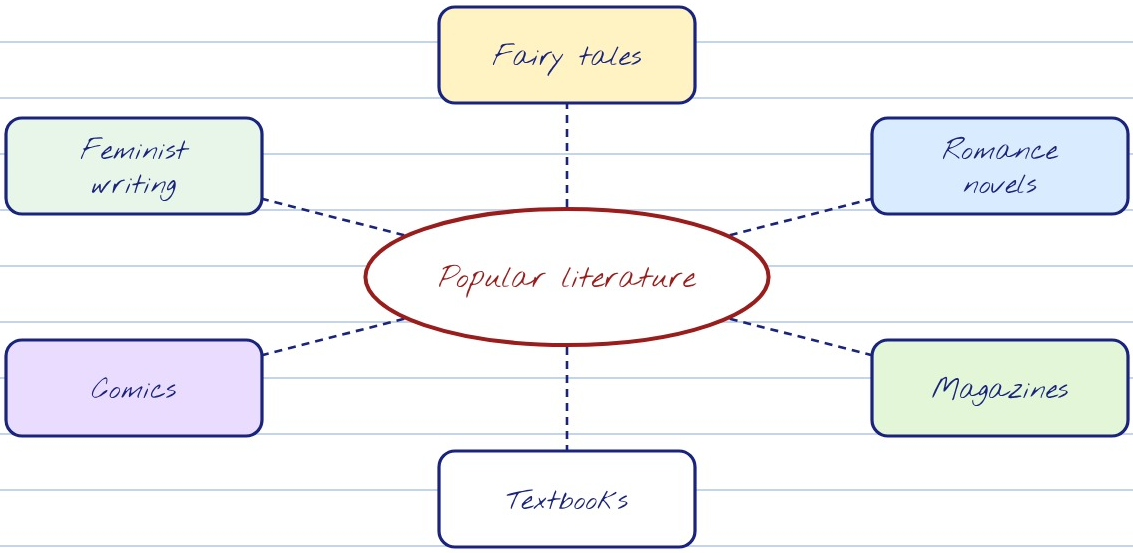
- **Indecent Representation of Women (Prohibition) Act, 1986** : bans indecent depiction in ads, publications, films.
- **ASCI Code** (Advertising Standards Council of India) : ads must not be demeaning to women.
- Cable TV Rules, CBFC certification, Press Council guidelines, IT Rules for online content.
- Good practice examples : campaigns breaking stereotypes (men sharing housework, diverse body types, "#ShareTheLoad").

5. Gender and Popular Literature

Q6. How is gender shown in popular literature (novels, magazines, comics, folktales)?

Ans. Popular books, romance novels, magazines and children's stories often keep old gender patterns - but women writers and feminist authors challenge them.

- **Folk and fairy tales** : passive princess waiting for rescue, evil stepmother and witch, hero is brave and saves.
- **Magazines** : women's magazines focus on beauty, cooking, relationships, men's on sports, cars, business.
- **Romance and thriller novels** : ideal of dominant male and submissive female, violence glamourised.
- **Textbooks** : men in professions, women at home, improved by gender audits.
- **Counter-narratives** : Ismat Chughtai, Mahasweta Devi, Kamala Das, Amrita Pritam, Arundhati Roy, Taslima Nasrin, Chitra Banerjee Divakaruni, Dalit and queer writing.



Read with a gender lens

- Who is the hero and who tells the story? Who speaks and who is silent?
- Are women shown as individuals or only in relation to men?
- Which values (power, honour, obedience) are praised?

6. Women in Sports, Music and Social Media

Q7. How are gender norms seen in sports, music and social media?

- **Sports** : women athletes get less coverage, pay and prize money, "girls can't play" myths, success of **P.V. Sindhu, Mary Kom, Mirabai Chanu, Saina Nehwal, Indian women's cricket team** challenges them.
- **Music and songs** : lyrics objectify women or glorify stalking, some songs promote respect and equality.

- **Social media** : beauty filters, body shaming, trolling of women who speak out, also platforms for solidarity.
- **Religion and tradition** : rituals that exclude menstruating women or restrict who may perform rites - debates on equal access (Sabarimala, Haji Ali cases).

Media literacy : 5 questions to ask

- 1. Who made this and why? 2. Who is shown, who is missing? 3. How are women and men portrayed?
- 4. What values are being sold? 5. How could it be shown fairly?

Q8. Case study - analyse an advertisement

- A soap advert shows only the mother cooking and washing while father reads the newspaper.
- Stereotype : housework = women's work. Effect : children learn unequal roles.
- Better version : both parents share chores, child of any gender helps.

7. Gender Development Issues

Q9. List major gender development issues in India.

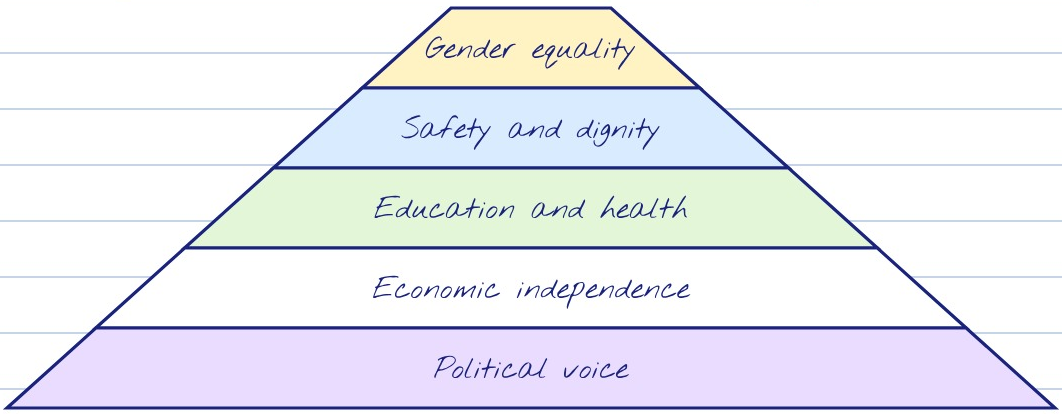
- **Education** : female literacy lags, girls' drop-out after puberty, safety and distance issues.
- **Health** : maternal mortality, anaemia, malnutrition, unsafe abortion, mental health ignored.
- **Work and income** : low female workforce participation, wage gap, unpaid care, no asset ownership.
- **Political** : low women's representation (Women's Reservation Act 2023 aims one-third).
- **Safety** : violence, trafficking, child marriage, harassment.
- **Digital divide** : fewer women own and use phones and internet.

Programme	Aim
Beti Bachao Beti Padhao (2015)	Girl child survival and education
Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana	Savings for girl child
Mahila Shakti Kendra, SHGs (NRLM)	Skills, credit, empowerment
Ujjwala Yojana	Clean cooking fuel for women
Poshan Abhiyaan	Nutrition of mothers and children
Women's Reservation Act 2023	One-third seats in legislatures

8. Gender Issues (Current Concerns)

Q10. Mention some contemporary gender issues.

- Violence and safety; unequal pay; glass ceiling; sexual harassment at work.
- Son preference and declining sex ratio; child marriage; dowry.
- Rights of **transgender and queer persons** : stigma, jobs, health.
- Women's reproductive rights and health; access to menstrual hygiene.
- Online abuse, cyber-stalking; portrayal in media; mental health of men and boys.
- Intersection of **gender with caste, class, religion, disability**.



9. Gender-Sensitive Language

Language both reflects and creates our attitudes. Words like "mankind" and "chairman" treat men as the default, proverbs and abuses often insult women.

Q11. What is gender-sensitive language? Give examples.

Ans. Language that treats all genders equally, avoids stereotypes and includes everyone.

Gender-biased	Gender-sensitive
Mankind	Humankind, people
Chairman	Chairperson, chair
Policeman, fireman	Police officer, firefighter
Businessman	Businessperson
Manpower	Workforce, staff
Housewife	Homemaker
Girl (for adult woman)	Woman
Lady doctor, male nurse	Doctor, nurse
He or his (for all)	They, he or she, the person

- Avoid sexist jokes, abuse based on women's bodies, and "boys will be boys".
- Use **neutral titles** (Ms.), pronouns people prefer, and inclusive terms for transgender persons.
- Use equal visuals and examples in classrooms, forms and documents.

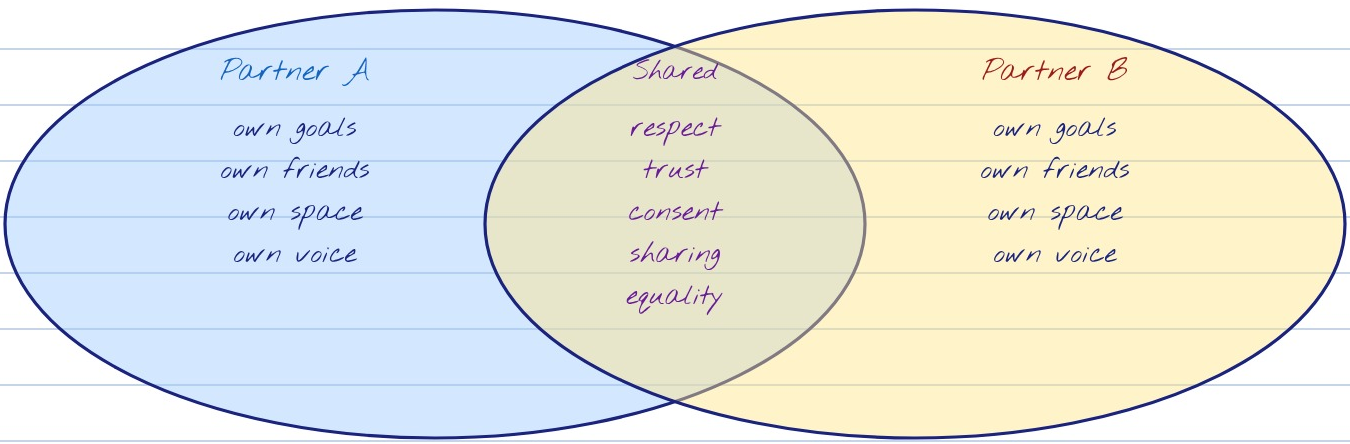
Change the words -> change the thought -> change the practice.

10. Just Relationships

Q12. What are "just relationships"? What are their key features?

Ans. Relationships based on equality, respect, consent, trust and shared responsibility - in family, friendship, love, work and society - free from domination and violence.

- **Mutual respect** and dignity; no superiority by gender, caste, class.
- **Consent** : "yes" is freely given; no pressure, no coercion; the right to say NO.
- **Equal decision making**; open communication and listening.
- **Shared responsibilities** : housework, parenting, money.
- **Non-violence** and accountability; space for individual growth and friendships.
- Support during conflict through dialogue, counselling, not control.



Signs of a healthy vs unhealthy relationship

- Healthy : trust, honesty, freedom, safety, equal say, Kindness in disagreement.
- Unhealthy : jealousy, control of phone and clothes, threats, put-downs, isolation, violence - seek help early.

11. Objective and Long Questions

Q13. Quick recall

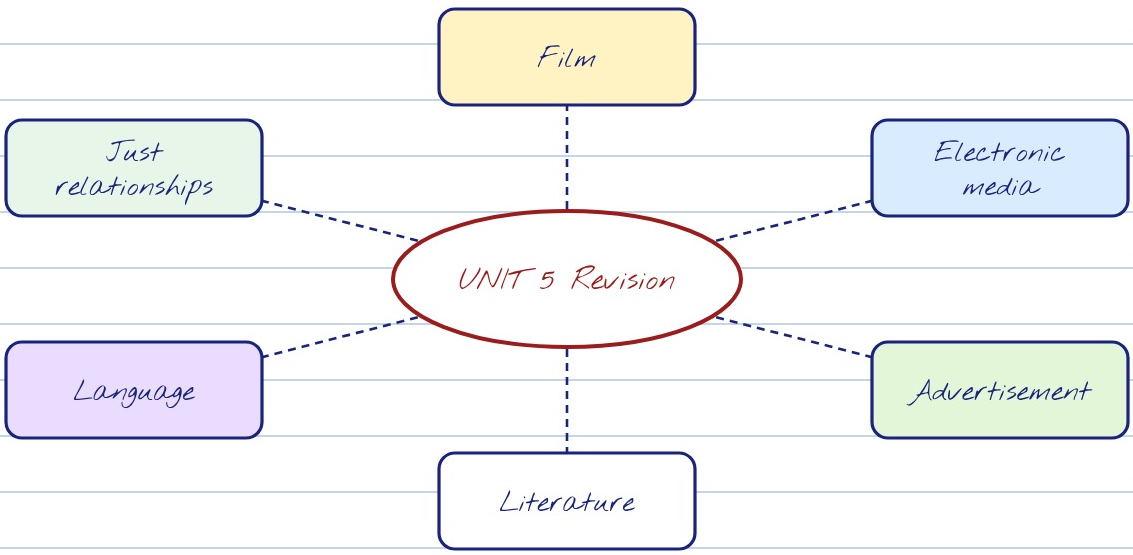
- 1. "Male gaze" - **Laura Mulvey**. 2. Bechdel test checks **women's presence in films**.
- 3. Indecent Representation of Women Act - **1986**. 4. Chairman -> **chairperson**.
- 5. Equal respect, consent and sharing = **just relationship**. 6. Community radio is a **positive** use of media.

Q14. Long answers

- 1. Portrayal of gender in film and electronic media. (Sec. 2, 3)
- 2. Gender and advertisement: stereotypes, laws and remedies. (Sec. 4)
- 3. Gender in popular literature, role of women writers. (Sec. 5)
- 4. Gender development issues and gender issues today. (Sec. 7, 8)
- 5. Gender-sensitive language and just relationships. (Sec. 9, 10)

Equal words, equal images, equal relationships = an equal world.

12. Two-Mark Questions and Quick Revision



Q15. Two-mark questions

- 1. **Male gaze** : looking at women through a heterosexual male viewpoint, as objects of pleasure.
- 2. **Objectification** : treating a person as a thing, valued only for looks.
- 3. **Stereotype in media** : repeated simplistic image such as the "ideal housewife".

> 4. **Media literacy** : ability to read and question media messages.
> 5. **Gender-sensitive language** : words that treat all genders equally and inclusively.
> 6. **Consent** : free, informed, reversible agreement without pressure.
> 7. **Bechdel test** : two named women talk to each other about something besides a man.
> 8. **ASCI** : self-regulatory body checking misleading or offensive advertisements.

Medium	Typical gender issue	Positive change
Film	Male gaze, item songs	Women-led stories
TV and OTT	Weepy, scheming women	Diverse characters
Advertisement	Housewife and sex object	Shared roles, real bodies
Social media	Trolling, body shaming	#MeToo, awareness